

Music & Acting

Year 1

Cambridge Early Years

Student Manual



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The Hedgerow Theatre

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PRIME BOOKS · CONTINUED

- **Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star**, English words, French tune. First published 1806. Words by Jane Taylor, published in *Rhymes for the Nursery*, 1806. The tune is the French *Ah! vous dirai-je, maman*, 1761. First verse only, which is the whole of Taylor's opening stanza.
- **The Grand Old Duke of York**, English traditional. First published 1913. Anonymous traditional. The modern wording reaches print in Arthur Rackham's *Mother Goose*, 1913. Actions are ours, not lifted from a modern songbook.
- **Row, Row, Row Your Boat**, American. First published 1852. FIRST VERSE ONLY. The 1852 words with the 1881 tune are clear. The familiar extra verses about crocodiles are modern street and commercial variants with no public-domain provenance, so they are not printed.
- **Bobby Shaftoe**, English, North East. First published 1805. Earliest printed version 1805; further verses in John Bell, *Rhymes of Northern Bards*, 1812. Tune from the Henry Atkinson manuscript, 1690s.
- **See Saw, Marjory Daw**, English traditional. First published c.1765. Anonymous traditional, Roud 13028. *Mother Goose's Melody*, London, c.1765. Related see-saw fragments run back to c.1640.
- **Hickory, Dickory, Dock**, English traditional. First published 1744. Anonymous traditional, Roud 6489. Tommy Thumb's *Pretty Song Book*, 1744, as *Hickere Dickere Dock*.
- **Ride a Cock Horse to Banbury Cross**, English, Oxfordshire. First published 1784. Anonymous traditional. A variant appears in Tommy Thumb's *Pretty Song Book*, c.1744; the modern wording in Gammer Gurton's *Garland*, 1784.
- **Oranges and Lemons**, English traditional. First published c.1744. Anonymous traditional, Roud 13190. Tommy Thumb's *Pretty Song Book*, c.1744. Opening couplets only: a Year 1 class sings the first pair of bells and passes under the arch.
- **London's Burning**, English traditional. First published before 1800. Anonymous traditional round. NOTE: the 1580 date often quoted attaches to the round's musical notation as *Scotland's Burning*, not to this wording, so the book does not claim 1580 for the words.
- **Frere Jacques**, French traditional. First published 1780. Anonymous traditional. Melody in a manuscript of c.1780 as *Frere Blaise*; words and music together, Paris, 1869. FRENCH, not British: the book says so rather than calling it a British song.
- **Old MacDonald Had a Farm**, English, later Anglo-American. First published 1719. Roud 745. Descends from Thomas d'Urfey's *In the Fields in Frost and Snow*, printed in *Wit and Mirth*, 1719; the E-I-E-I-O form standardised by the 1920s. OUR OWN animal list and layout, so no modern arranger's verse set is reproduced.



The instruments of the Hedgerow Theatre, laid out for putting away.

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Safety. The activities in this book are designed for a classroom with a teacher present. Where an activity invites loud playing, a "Safe ears" note appears beside it. Please read those notes with the class.

Scheme of work. The five units and twenty-five topics of this book follow the Music and Drama Year 1 scheme of work exactly, in the same order and under the same headings, so that any page can be matched to the scheme at a glance. The scheme's own wording for each topic is printed in the contents.

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PRIME SCHOOL



Pip.

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The company of the Hedgerow Theatre, all seven of them.

WELCOME

The Hedgerow Theatre

There is a gap in the hedge at the bottom of the field. Somebody, nobody knows who, built a little stage in it out of old boards. There is a curtain the colour of flowerpots, a painted cloth at the back, and just enough room on the boards for everybody at once.

This year, the stage is yours.



Everybody arrives. Nobody has played a note yet.

CURTAIN UP

You are going to sing. You are going to bang, shake, tap and scrape. You are going to walk to a beat, make a journey out of sound, pretend to be somebody else, and stand up in front of people and show them what you made.

Here is the one big idea of the whole book:

A sound is something you make on purpose.

Not a noise that just happens. A sound that **you choose**. Loud or soft. High or low. Fast or slow. Long or short. And you choose when it starts, and when it stops.

The same four things, every time

Every single thing you do in this book goes round the same little circle. When you get stuck, come back here.

1 Listen. Before you make any sound at all, hear it. Hear it outside you, or hear it in your head.

2 Try. Have a go. It does not have to be right. The first go almost never is, and that is completely fine.

3 Choose. Now pick. Louder or softer? Faster or slower? This one or that one? This is the important step, and it is the one people forget.

4 Show. Give it to somebody. A partner, the class, the whole school. A sound nobody hears is only half finished.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK • CONTINUED



Otto listens. Nutkin tries. Bramble chooses. Pip shows.

FOR TEACHERS

This book follows the Music and Drama Year 1 scheme of work exactly: five units, twenty-five topics, in the scheme's order and under the scheme's headings. Each topic opens with the pupil-facing title and carries the scheme's own wording in the contents.

Pupils are addressed directly throughout. Panels headed **For teachers**, like this one, are the only places where the book speaks to you rather than to the class.

The four-step loop above is the spine of every unit. It is worth teaching as a routine in the first week, because from Unit 2 onwards the tasks assume pupils know it.

The signs on the page

Some jobs in this book have a little sign next to them. Here is what each one means.

- 1 A green tie down the side means **Voice off**: you need no instrument at all for this one. Just you, your voice, your hands and your feet.

VOICE OFF

- 2 An orange tie means **Sing it**: this is a singing or chanting job, so open your mouth and let it out.

SING IT



Safe ears. Wherever you see this, there is loud playing about. Look after your own ears, and look after everybody else's too.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK • CONTINUED

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

Deep inside your ear is a tiny skin called the eardrum. Sound makes it wobble, and it passes the wobble on to the three smallest bones in your whole body.

Otto asks a question about something you did before. He is the one who remembers.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Badger sets the hard one. You do not have to do it, but he thinks you probably can.

Making a stage in your room

You do not need a real theatre. You need a space, and everybody facing the same way.



Badger takes the rope. Bramble lays the instruments out in a row. Hattie sweeps the boards.

- 1 Clear a space.** Push the tables back. Leave a patch of floor big enough for four people to stand in a line.
- 2 Mark the front.** A line of tape on the floor is your edge of the stage. Do not stand behind it when it is your turn.
- 3 Set out the instruments.** In a row, along one side, all facing the same way. Then everyone can see what there is.
- 4 Agree the two signals.** One from your teacher that means **start**, and one that means **stop**. A hand going up is the easiest stop signal there is.

GETTING SET UP • CONTINUED

FOR TEACHERS

A taped line and two agreed hand signals do more for a Year 1 music lesson than any amount of equipment. Establish both before the first instrument comes out of the cupboard.

The instruments named in this book are the standard EYFS and Key Stage 1 set: untuned percussion (tambourine, triangle, claves, wood block, shakers, maracas, hand drum, jingle bells, guiro, cymbals) and simple tuned percussion (xylophone, glockenspiel, chime bars). Where a page names one you do not have, substitute freely: the learning is in the choosing, not the object.



A xylophone: eight bars, longest to shortest.

Four rules of the Hedgerow Theatre

Everybody who steps on these boards agrees to these. They are short on purpose.

1 When somebody is playing, everybody else is listening. That is the whole deal. You get listened to because you listen.

2 An instrument is not a toy, and it is not a hammer. Play it the way it wants to be played, and it will still work next year.

3 Silence is part of the music. The quiet before you start and the quiet after you finish both belong to the piece.

4 Nobody laughs at a wrong note. Everybody plays wrong notes. The only people who do not are the people who never try.

 **Safe ears.** Loud is fun for a moment and tiring for an hour. If a sound makes you want to move away from it, that is your ears being sensible. Listen to them.

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

Your ears can hear about 20 wobbles a second at the lowest and 20,000 a second at the highest. Anything slower or faster is silent to you.

UNIT 1

The Green Room

Your voice is yours, and it can do more than talk.

- 1 Wake up your voice
- 2 Songs we already know
- 3 Learning a song, line by line
- 4 I sing, you sing
- 5 Our first show



TOPIC 1.1

Wake up your voice



Pip leads the warm up. Everybody copies, beaks and mouths wide open.

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Pip the robin was on the boards before anybody else, and she was not singing yet. She was yawning.

Nutkin thought that was very rude. But Pip knows something: a voice that has been asleep all night cannot sing straight away. It has to wake up first, and a big yawn is the fastest way to wake it.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ wake your voice up before you sing
- ★ make your voice go high and low on purpose
- ★ find the four voices everybody has

warm
up

Yawn. A big one, with your arms up. Now do it again and let a sound come out of the yawn, going from high down to low. That is your voice waking up.

TOPIC 1.1 · CONTINUED

 YOU HAVE FOUR VOICES

Everybody has four different voices, and they all come out of the same mouth. You choose which one to use.

your talking voice**your whispering voice****your calling voice****your singing voice**

A whisper is not just a quiet talk. Put your hand on your throat and whisper, then talk. Feel the difference? Talking buzzes. Whispering does not buzz at all.

 HIGH AND LOW

A high sound is not a loud sound. That catches everybody out. High and low are about how **fast** something is wobbling, not how big it is. You can sing a high note very quietly, and a low note very loudly.

**high, like a mouse****middle, like talking****low, like a big dog**

TOPIC 1.1 • CONTINUED



Nutkin wakes his voice up.



Hattie whispers. No buzz.

YOUR TURN

- 1 Yawn and stretch three times. On the third one, let a sound slide out of your mouth from as high as you can go down to as low as you can go.

wheee, all the way down

SING IT

- 2 Put two fingers gently on the front of your throat. Say your own name. Now whisper it. Which one made your fingers buzz?

- 3 Be a mouse: say hello in your highest voice. Now be a big dog: say hello in your lowest. Now be you.

- 4 Sing the same note twice, first as loudly as you can and then as softly as you can. Did the note stay in the same place, high or low?

TOPIC 1.1 • CONTINUED

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

Inside your throat are two small stretchy bands called vocal folds. When you speak they snap together and buzz as air rushes past them from your lungs.

► ONE STEP MORE

Slide your voice slowly from your lowest note to your highest without any bumps in it, like a slide in a playground and not like stairs. It is harder than it sounds.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Sing one note and hold it while your partner walks all the way across the room. Take a big breath first. No running out halfway.

♪ Words from Topic 1.1

**sing**

your singing voice

**high**

a fast wobble

**low**

a slow wobble

**listen**

the first job of all



No books, no papers. Everybody singing from memory, with Bramble keeping a gentle beat on his knees.

TOPIC 1.2

Songs we already know

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Otto asked everybody to sing a song they already knew. Six of them started, and all six started a different song.

Tessa said, very slowly, that perhaps somebody should choose first. She is often right about things like that.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ sing a song you already know, all the way through
- ★ start together, because somebody counts you in
- ★ notice that you carry songs about in your head

warm
up

Hum. Any note, mouth closed, for as long as one breath lasts. Now hum the first line of a song you know without telling anybody which one, and see if your partner can guess it.

TOPIC 1.2 • CONTINUED

Which of your four voices are you using when you hum?
Is your mouth open or shut, and can you still hear the
tune?

🎵 **YOU ALREADY KNOW A LOT OF SONGS**

Nobody taught you most of them on purpose. You picked them up, the way you picked up how to walk. They are already in your head, which means you already are a singer.

Here is one that has been sung to children for over two hundred years. A lady called Jane Taylor wrote the words in 1806.

Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star

Twinkle, twinkle, little star,
How I wonder what you are!
Up above the world so high,
Like a diamond in the sky.

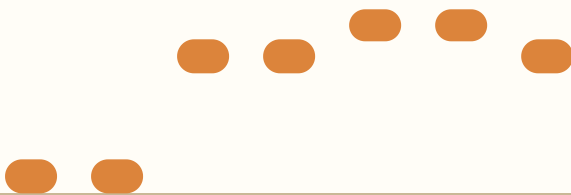
TOPIC 1.2 · CONTINUED

 STARTING TOGETHER

A song that starts raggedly never quite recovers. So somebody always counts you in. Badger does it like this:

Ready ... steady ... off we go!

Three words, the same speed as the song. By the third word everybody knows exactly when to open their mouth.

TWINKLE, TWINKLE: WATCH THE TUNE JUMP UP ON THE THIRD NOTE**YOUR TURN**

- 1 Sing Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star all the way to the end without stopping. Somebody counts you in first.

ready, steady, off we go

SING IT

- 2 Choose a song you all know. Put your hand up if you know it. If most hands go up, that is the one to sing.

TOPIC 1.2 · CONTINUED

- 3 Sing the first line of Twinkle out loud, then sing the second line inside your head, then the third line out loud again. Keep going in your head at the same speed.

SING IT

- 4 Frere Jacques is a French song, and it has been sung for over two hundred years too. Learn the first line and sing it as a round: one half of the class starts, the other half waits and starts later.

 PIP'S TRUE THING

No two people's voices are exactly the same. The shape of your throat, the roof of your mouth and your vocal folds all belong only to you, so your friends know it is you before they turn round.

 ONE STEP MORE

Sing Twinkle again, but every time you get to the word star, sing it as high as you comfortably can. The rest stays where it was.

TOPIC 1.2 · CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Sing the whole of Frere Jacques as a round in two halves without either half speeding up to catch the other. That is much harder than it looks.

🎵 Words from Topic 1.2

**song**

words and a tune
together

**tune**

the shape a song makes

**start**

everybody at the same
moment

**hum**

singing with your mouth
closed

TOPIC 1.3

Learning a song, line by line

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Pip wanted to teach everybody a song nobody knew. She sang the whole thing straight through, twice, quite fast. Nobody learned any of it.

So she tried again, one line at a time, and waited after each one. By the fourth line even Nutkin had it, and Nutkin was not really concentrating.



Pip sings one line and raises her wing. Everybody watches the wing, mouths closed, waiting.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ learn a new song one line at a time
- ★ copy a line back exactly as you heard it
- ★ add an action that helps you remember the words

warm
up

Copy the sound. Your teacher makes a short sound and you make exactly the same one back. Listen right to the end before you start: that is the whole trick.

TOPIC 1.3 • CONTINUED

When Pip sang the whole song twice, nobody learned it. When she sang one line and waited, everybody did. Why do you think that is?

 LINE BY LINE, AND WAIT

This is how everybody learns a song, including grown-up singers.

One person sings **one line**. Then they stop and **wait**. Then everybody sings that same line back. Then the next line. Then both lines joined together. Then the next one.

The waiting is the important part. You cannot copy something while it is still going on.

 ACTIONS HOLD THE WORDS FOR YOU

Do the same action every time you sing a line, and your body starts to remember the words for you. When you forget a word, do the action and it very often comes back.

TOPIC 1.3 · CONTINUED

- 1 Listen to the line. All of it. Do not join in yet.
- 2 Sing it back. If it went wrong, that is useful: now you know which bit is tricky.
- 3 Add the action, and sing it again with the action.
- 4 Join it on to the line before. Now you have two.

YOUR TURN

- 1 Learn Bobby Shaftoe line by line from your teacher. One line, wait, sing it back. Do not go on until everybody has it. SING IT
- 2 Make up one action for each line of Bobby Shaftoe. Everybody must do the same action, so agree them as a class first.
- 3 Sing the whole song with the actions. Now sing it again with the actions but no words, only in your head. Did your hands still know where they were?
- 4 Take turns to be the teacher. One person sings a line of their own invention, everybody else copies it back exactly.
your turn to lead

TOPIC 1.3 • CONTINUED

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

Your vocal folds are only a few millimetres long. Small bands wobble faster than big ones, and faster wobbles make higher sounds, which is why your voice is higher than a grown-up's.

► ONE STEP MORE

Try teaching a line to somebody who was away. You will find out very quickly how much of it you really know.

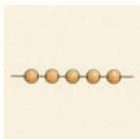
★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Learn all four lines of Bobby Shaftoe by heart today, actions and all, and sing it tomorrow without any help at all.

♪ Words from Topic 1.3

**copy**

do exactly what you heard

**line**

one row of a song

**action**

a movement that helps you remember

**by heart**

you can do it with the book shut

TOPIC 1.4

I sing, you sing



Pip and Nutkin sing on the left. Otto, Hattie and Tessa wait on the right with one wing raised: they are next.

♪ ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Nutkin does not like waiting. When Pip sang her line, he sang his straight over the top of it, and the two of them sounded like a squabble.

Badger stopped them and made a rule: one side sings, then the other side answers. Nobody sings while somebody else is singing. It worked immediately.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ sing back an answer after somebody else has finished
- ★ wait for your turn without filling the gap
- ★ sing in two groups without either group speeding up

TOPIC 1.4 • CONTINUED

warm
up

Echo game. Your teacher claps a short pattern and you clap it back, but only after they have finished. If you join in early, you are copying the beginning and guessing the end.

In Topic 1.3 you copied a line back exactly. Now you are going to answer with something different. What has to happen in between?

 CALL AND ANSWER

One person **calls**. Everybody **answers**. It is the oldest way of singing together there is, and sailors, soldiers and farm workers all used it, because you can sing it while your hands are busy.

The important bit is the gap. The answer starts exactly where the call stopped: no sooner, and no later.

 TAKING TURNS IS A MUSICAL SKILL

Waiting quietly for your turn does not feel like music, but it is. The silence you leave is what makes the other person's line sound like a line. Fill the gap, and you have wrecked both.

TOPIC 1.4 • CONTINUED



call



gap



answer



gap



call



gap



everybody



Pip calls with her beak open. Otto's beak is shut and his wing is up: he is waiting, not singing.

YOUR TURN

- 1 Split into two halves. One half sings London's Burning, one line each, and the other half answers with the next line. Swap over and do it again.

SING IT

- 2 Play the name game. One person sings 'Where is Hattie?' and Hattie sings back 'Here I am!' on the same two notes. Go round everybody.

where is ... here I am

- 3 Sing London's Burning as a proper round in two halves. The second half starts when the first half reaches the second line.

- 4 Now do it silently. One half claps the pattern of the words while the other half sings. Then swap.

TOPIC 1.4 • CONTINUED

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

High up inside the dome of St Paul's Cathedral in London you can whisper against the curved wall, and a friend on the far side will hear you perfectly. It is 257 steps up.

► ONE STEP MORE

Try the answer with your eyes shut. You will find you were watching the caller's mouth to know when to come in, and now you have to listen instead.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Three groups, not two. Group one sings, group two answers, group three answers group two. Nobody overlaps anybody.

♪ Words from Topic 1.4

**call**

you sing first

**answer**

you sing back afterwards

**gap**

the silence in between

**turn**

your moment, and nobody else's



The first show. Three of them on the lit boards, four of them below, watching.

TOPIC 1.5

Our first show

♪ ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Hattie did not want to stand at the front. She said her voice was too small and everybody would hear it wobble.

Pip said that everybody's voice wobbles the first time, including hers, and that the wobble goes away by about the third bar. Hattie stood at the front. It did.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ stand up and sing to somebody who is listening
- ★ start and finish together, on a signal
- ★ say one true thing about how it went

warm
up

Stand in a line, all facing the same way, feet still, hands by your sides. Take one slow breath in together, and let it out together. That is what a performance starts with.

TOPIC 1.5 • CONTINUED

Otto asks: what are the four things in the little circle at the front of this book? You have done three of them already today.

 WHAT AN AUDIENCE IS FOR

An audience is not there to catch you out. They are there because they want to hear it. That is the whole reason they sat down.

Your job when you are in the audience is just as real as your job on the boards: be still, be quiet, and look at whoever is singing. Then clap, properly, at the end.

 HOW TO FINISH

Lots of people can start. Finishing is the hard part. Sing the last word, keep still for the length of one breath, and only then relax. If you run off the moment the song stops, the ending falls over.

TOPIC 1.5 • CONTINUED



Feet still. All facing the same way.



Hattie takes her bow. One paw across her middle.



The other job: being an audience.

YOUR TURN

- 1 In groups of three or four, choose one song you have learned this unit and sing it to the rest of the class. Badger's signal starts you.

SING IT

- 2 When you are the audience: sit still, watch the singers, and clap at the end. No talking while somebody is singing.

- 3 Practise the ending on its own, five times. Last word, one breath of stillness, then relax. Nothing else.

TOPIC 1.5 • CONTINUED

- 4 After your turn, say one thing that went well and one thing you would change. Just one of each, out loud.

VOICE OFF

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

Robins sometimes sing right through the night. Street lights fool them into thinking that morning has come.

➤ ONE STEP MORE

Sing your song to a different audience: another class, or the grown-ups at the end of the day. The song does not change, but it will feel completely different.

TOPIC 1.5 • CONTINUED • CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Sing on your own, just you, to the whole class. You do not have to. Badger thinks you probably can.

🎵 Words from Topic 1.5

**stage**

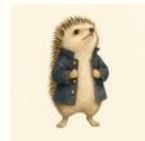
the place you stand to perform

**audience**

the people who are listening

**clap**

how we say thank you

**perform**

to give it to somebody

END OF UNIT 1

The Green Room: what can you do?

Tick the ones you can do. If a box is empty, that is not a problem: it just tells you what to have another go at.

- ☐ I can wake my voice up before I sing
- ☐ I can make my voice go high and low when I choose
- ☐ I can sing a song I know all the way through
- ☐ I can learn a new song one line at a time
- ☐ I can wait for my turn, and answer when it comes
- ☐ I can stand up and sing to people who are listening
- ☐ I can be a good audience for somebody else



Hattie sang at the front, and the wobble went away.

END OF UNIT 1 • CONTINUED

How did it go?

Colour one circle for each line. Green for yes, yellow for nearly, orange for not yet.

Singing a song I already knew	☐ ☐ ☐
Learning a brand new song	☐ ☐ ☐
Waiting for my turn without filling the gap	☐ ☐ ☐
Standing at the front	☐ ☐ ☐
Being an audience	☐ ☐ ☐

 FOR TEACHERS

Unit 1 establishes three routines the rest of the book relies on: the vocal warm up, the count-in, and the line-by-line teaching sequence in Topic 1.3. Pupils who have those three can be taught any song in this book.

The comfortable singing range for this age group is narrow. Every melody printed in this book is checked against it, so pitching a song well above or below where it is printed will make it harder than it needs to be.

Topic 1.5 is the first performance of the year. Keep the audience small and the song short. What is being assessed is starting together, finishing together, and being heard, not polish.

UNIT 2

The Sound Cupboard

Every object has a voice, and you choose how to use it.

- 1 Open the sound cupboard
- 2 Loud and soft, high and low, fast and slow
- 3 Make a sound pattern
- 4 Listen to the world outside
- 5 Play it together



TOPIC 2.1

Open the sound cupboard



The cupboard is open. Bramble, Nutkin and Hattie each lift one instrument out and look at it properly.

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Badger unlocked the tall cupboard beside the stage, and Nutkin got to it first. He grabbed the biggest drum and hit it as hard as he could.

Badger took it back. Not because Nutkin was naughty, but because he had not listened to it first. Every single thing in that cupboard has its own voice, and you cannot choose a voice you have never heard.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ find out what each instrument sounds like
- ★ hold and play each one the way it wants to be played
- ★ sort instruments into shake, tap and scrape

TOPIC 2.1 • CONTINUED



Pass the sound round the circle. Your teacher gives one instrument to the first person. Play it once, quietly, then pass it on. Everybody gets one turn and nobody plays twice.

In Unit 1 you found four different voices in your own mouth. How many voices do you think one drum has?

🎵 THREE WAYS TO MAKE A SOUND

Almost everything in the cupboard is played in one of three ways.

Shake it. Maracas, shakers, jingle bells. Something loose inside or outside knocks about.

Tap it. Drums, wood blocks, triangles, claves. You hit it and it rings or thuds.

Scrape it. A guiro, sand blocks, a comb. You drag something across ridges.

Pick anything up and ask yourself which of the three it wants. Get it wrong and it hardly makes a sound at all.

TOPIC 2.1 • CONTINUED

 HOLD IT PROPERLY AND IT SINGS

A triangle held tight in your fist goes *tink* and stops dead. Held by its cord it rings on and on. Nothing about the triangle changed: your hand was stopping it.

That is true of nearly everything here. Let it be free and it will sing for you.



One paw shakes, one taps, one scrapes.

Shake it

Tap it

Scrape it

YOUR TURN

Safe ears. The cupboard has some very loud things in it. One tap is plenty to find out what something sounds like. Save the big noise for when the music needs it.

TOPIC 2.1 • CONTINUED

- 1 Choose one instrument. Play it three times: as quietly as you can, normally, then as loudly as is sensible. Which of the three did you like best?
- 2 Hold a triangle tight in your fist and tap it. Now hang it from its cord and tap it again. Say out loud what changed.
- 3 Sort the instruments on your table into the three trays above: shake, tap and scrape. Some are tricky, so talk about those ones.
- 4 Close your eyes while a partner plays one instrument behind your back. Can you name it from the sound alone?
VOICE OFF
- 5 Now make a cupboard sound with no instrument at all: shake your hands, tap your knees, scrape your palms together.

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

Every sound in the world is made by something wobbling to and fro. We call that wobbling a vibration, and it makes the air wobble too.

TOPIC 2.1 • CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Find three things in your classroom that are not instruments but have a good voice anyway. A tin, a lid, a bunch of keys.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Play one instrument so quietly that the person furthest away can only just hear it. Not silent. Only just.

🎵 Words from Topic 2.1

**instrument**

a thing made for making music

**shake**

loose bits knock about

**tap**

hit it and it rings

**scrape**

drag across the ridges



Bramble hits hard, Tessa taps gently, Nutkin shakes fast. Three different choices, side by side.

TOPIC 2.2

Loud and soft, high and low, fast and slow

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Tessa played the triangle once, so softly that everybody leaned in. Then Nutkin played it as fast as he possibly could, about forty times.

Otto said something useful: they had both played the same triangle, and it had sounded like two completely different instruments. The triangle did not change. The choosing did.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ choose loud or soft on purpose
- ★ choose fast or slow on purpose
- ★ hear whether a sound is high or low
- ★ use the proper words for all three

TOPIC 2.2 · CONTINUED



Follow the hand. When your teacher's hand is high up, play high or loud. When it comes down low, go quiet. Watch, do not guess.

Otto asks: is a high sound always a loud sound? You worked this out in Topic 1.1 with your own voice.

♪ LOUD AND SOFT

These are the two words musicians use, and they are about **how much sound** you make. Nothing else changes.

Loud is not better. A whole piece played loud is exhausting, and a quiet moment is what makes a loud one exciting.

♪ FAST AND SLOW

This is about **how often** the sounds come, not how big they are. Tessa walks slowly. Nutkin runs. Both of them can be quiet.

TOPIC 2.2 · CONTINUED

 HIGH AND LOW

A big drum sounds low. A little bell sounds high. Big things wobble slowly and slow wobbles are low sounds, which is exactly the same rule you found in your own throat.

HOW MUCH SOUND?

 **loud** a big sound

 **middle** an ordinary sound

 **soft** a little sound

HOW FAST?

 **very slow** 52 to 60 beats a minute

 **slow** 60 to 76 beats a minute

 **walking** 76 to 100 beats a minute

 **quick** 100 to 126 beats a minute

 **very quick** 126 to 144 beats a minute

TOPIC 2.2 · CONTINUED



A big drum and a little drum.



The same drum, two different choices.

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. Loud is a choice, not a competition. If somebody near you covers their ears, you have gone past useful and into uncomfortable.

- 1 Play one instrument four ways: loud and slow, loud and fast, soft and slow, soft and fast. All four are different pieces of music.
- 2 Line up three instruments from lowest to highest. Play them in order, then backwards.
- 3 Your teacher plays something. Say whether it was loud or soft, and whether it was fast or slow. Two answers every time.
VOICE OFF
- 4 Sing Old MacDonald once quickly and once very slowly. Which one was funnier, and which one was easier to sing?

TOPIC 2.2 · CONTINUED

- 5 Be Tessa: walk and clap slowly. Be Nutkin: run on the spot and clap quickly. No instruments needed.

VOICE OFF

 PIP'S TRUE THING

A big drum has more air inside it to shake, and big things shake more slowly. Slow shaking makes a low sound, so the biggest drum in the band is always the deepest.

 ONE STEP MORE

Find the lowest sound in the whole room and the highest sound in the whole room. They might not be instruments.

 BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Play a pattern that starts soft and slow and gets louder and faster all the way to the end, with no jumps in it.

TOPIC 2.2 • CONTINUED

🎵 Words from Topic 2.2

**loud**

a big sound

**soft**

a little sound

**fast**

the sounds come often

**slow**

the sounds come rarely

**high**

a fast wobble

**low**

a slow wobble

TOPIC 2.3

Make a sound pattern

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Bramble made up a pattern: tap, tap, rest, tap. He did it four times exactly the same and everybody joined in by the third go.

Then Nutkin made one up too, but he did something different every time, so nobody could join in at all. A pattern is only a pattern if it comes back.



Four of them frozen at different points of one repeating pattern. Otto is the silent one.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ make up a short sound pattern
- ★ repeat your pattern exactly the same each time
- ★ leave a silence in a pattern on purpose
- ★ add a movement that matches your sound

warm
up

Clap this back: clap, clap, rest, clap. Now again. Now with a stamp instead of the last clap. The rest is a real part of it, so do not fill it in.

TOPIC 2.3 · CONTINUED

Which of these is a pattern: a sound that changes every time, or a sound that comes back the same?

 A PATTERN COMES BACK

Four beats, then start again. That is all a pattern is at this stage, and it is enough to make real music with.

Say **ta** for a sound and **sh** for a silence. Now you can write a pattern down with your mouth before you play a note.

 THE SILENCE IS NOT A MISTAKE

A rest is a beat where you deliberately play nothing. It is the hardest part, because your hands want to fill it. Count it in your head: the silence takes up just as much room as the sound.

PATTERN ONE: FOUR SOUNDS

ta ta ta ta

PATTERN TWO: A SILENCE IN THE MIDDLE

ta ta sh ta

TOPIC 2.3 · CONTINUED

PATTERN THREE: SOUND, SILENCE, SOUND, SILENCE

ta sh ta sh



tap



tap



shh



tap

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. Patterns get repeated a lot, so choose a sound you and everybody near you can bear to hear twenty times.

- 1 Say Pattern two out loud four times without stopping: ta, ta, sh, ta. Keep the sh completely silent.

ta ta sh ta

VOICE OFF

- 2 Now clap Pattern two instead of saying it. Your hands must be still on the sh.

- 3 Play Pattern two on any instrument. Four times exactly the same, then stop.

- 4 Make up your own four-beat pattern with at least one sh in it. Say it, then clap it, then play it.

TOPIC 2.3 • CONTINUED

- 5 Add a movement to your pattern: a step, a turn, a hand in the air. The same movement in the same place every time.

VOICE OFF

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

A cricket has no voice at all. He makes his chirp by rubbing one wing quickly across the other, a little like a bow across a violin string.

➤ ONE STEP MORE

Two patterns at once. Half the class plays Pattern one while the other half plays Pattern three. Start together.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Make an eight-beat pattern by joining two four-beat patterns together, and play it without looking at the page.

♪ Words from Topic 2.3



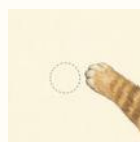
pattern

it comes back the same



beat

one step of the music



rest

a beat where you play nothing



repeat

do it again the same way

TOPIC 2.4

Listen to the world outside



Otto on a gate post at dusk, listening to rain on leaves, a distant tower, wind in the grasses.

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Otto sat on the gate post for a whole hour without playing anything at all. Nutkin asked him what he was doing.

Otto said he was working. He had heard eleven different sounds and he could tell which direction every one of them came from. That is a real skill, and it is the one this whole book stands on.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ sit still and hear what is really there
- ★ name a sound and say where it came from
- ★ copy a sound from outside with your voice or an instrument
- ★ sort sounds into near and far

TOPIC 2.4 • CONTINUED



One minute of complete silence, everybody. Count the different sounds you can hear on your fingers. Do not say them out loud until the minute is over.

Otto asks: what did you hear in the silence that you had never noticed before?

🎵 **THE WORLD IS ALREADY MAKING MUSIC**

Nobody wrote it and nobody is conducting it, but it is going on all the time: rain, wind, birds, traffic, a door, your own breathing.

A composer is somebody who listens to that and then chooses bits of it on purpose. You are about to do the same thing.

🎵 **NEAR AND FAR**

A near sound is clear and you can hear its edges. A far sound is softer and smudged, and it arrives a moment later than you expect.

Shut your eyes and you can usually point at a sound. Your two ears hear it at very slightly different moments, and your head does the sums for you.

TOPIC 2.4 • CONTINUED



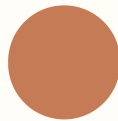
Otto, working.

Sounds from near

Sounds from far away



a bird



a lorry



the wind



nothing



a door

YOUR TURN

Safe ears. The quietest work in this book is also the most useful. You cannot hear a far-off sound over your own noise.

1

Go outside, or open a window. Sit still for two minutes and count the sounds. Write down or draw the three most interesting ones.

VOICE OFF

TOPIC 2.4 • CONTINUED

2 Sort your sounds into the two trays above: near, or far away. VOICE OFF

3 Copy one of your sounds with your voice. Just your voice, no instrument.

4 Now copy the same sound with an instrument. Which was closer to the real thing, your voice or the instrument?

5 Shut your eyes while a partner makes a sound somewhere in the room. Point at where it came from without opening your eyes.

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

Deep inside your ear is a tiny skin called the eardrum. Sound makes it wobble, and it passes the wobble on to the three smallest bones in your whole body.

► ONE STEP MORE

Listen at a different time of day. The same place sounds completely different first thing in the morning.

TOPIC 2.4 • CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Make a sound that nobody in the class can identify with their eyes shut. You are allowed to use anything in the room.

♪ Words from Topic 2.4

**listen**

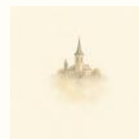
hear it on purpose

**sound**

anything your ears can catch

**near**

clear, with edges

**far**

soft and smudged



A small band on the boards, everybody watching Badger, who has one paw raised to hold them steady.

TOPIC 2.5

Play it together

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Four of them played together for the first time and it was a disaster. Everybody started when they felt like it and nobody could hear anybody else.

So Badger stood at the side and raised one paw. Nobody plays until the paw comes down, and everybody stops when it goes up. They tried again and it sounded like a band.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ play at the same time as other people
- ★ start and stop on a signal
- ★ listen to the group while you are playing
- ★ say what your group did well

warm
up

Everybody plays one single sound, all at exactly the same moment, on Badger's signal. Just one. Then do it again. It is much harder than it sounds.

TOPIC 2.5 · CONTINUED

You learned to wait for your turn in Topic 1.4. What is different when everybody plays at once?

🎵 TWO SIGNALS ARE ALL YOU NEED

Paw down: start. Paw up: stop.

That is a conductor. Somebody has to be watching the whole thing from outside, because the person playing the drum cannot hear how loud the drum is compared to everything else.

🎵 PLAYING TOGETHER MEANS LISTENING WHILE YOU PLAY

This is the hard bit. If you can only hear yourself, you are playing too loudly. Turn yourself down until you can hear the person next to you as well, and the whole thing suddenly sounds like music.

TOPIC 2.5 • CONTINUED

1 Choose your instrument and hold it ready. Do not play it.

2 Watch the conductor. Not the page, not your hands.

3 Paw down: everybody in, on the same beat.

4 Play your pattern, and listen for the person beside you.

5 Paw up: everybody out, together. Then keep still.

FOUR BEATS, PLAYING ON ONE AND THREE

1**2****3****4**

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. A whole group playing at once is much louder than one person. Play softer in a group than you would on your own, and everybody can hear everybody.

1 In fours, choose one instrument each and one pattern from Topic 2.3. Play it together on Badger's signal. Stop together too.

TOPIC 2.5 · CONTINUED

- 2 Take turns being the conductor. Paw down to start, paw up to stop, and hold your group steady in between.

VOICE OFF

- 3 Play your group piece again, but this time make it start soft and end loud. The conductor decides when it grows.

- 4 Perform your group piece to the rest of the class. Everybody else is the audience, so sit still and listen properly.

- 5 Afterwards, say one thing your group did well. Not what went wrong: what went right.

 PIP'S TRUE THING

The loudest sound any animal makes belongs to the sperm whale. Its clicks are far louder than a clap of thunder.

 ONE STEP MORE

Try it with no conductor at all. One person breathes in loudly and everybody starts on the breath. That is how real bands do it.

TOPIC 2.5 • CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Your group plays for exactly eight beats and stops dead. No conductor, no counting out loud. Count in your heads.

🎵 Words from Topic 2.5

**conductor**

the one who starts and stops you

**together**

at the same moment

**signal**

a sign that means go, or stop

**band**

people playing at the same time

END OF UNIT 2

The Sound Cupboard: what can you do?

Tick the ones you can do. If a box is empty, that is not a problem: it just tells you what to have another go at.

☐ I can find out what an instrument sounds like before I play it

☐ I can hold an instrument so it rings properly

☐ I can choose loud or soft on purpose

☐ I can choose fast or slow on purpose

☐ I can hear whether a sound is high or low

☐ I can make a four-beat pattern and repeat it

☐ I can leave a silence in a pattern

☐ I can sit still and listen to the world outside

☐ I can start and stop with everybody else



Eight bars, longest to shortest. Long bars are low.

END OF UNIT 2 • CONTINUED

How did it go?

Colour one circle for each line. Green for yes, yellow for nearly, orange for not yet.

Finding the right way to play each instrument	☐ ☐ ☐
Choosing loud or soft, fast or slow	☐ ☐ ☐
Repeating my pattern exactly	☐ ☐ ☐
Keeping the rest silent	☐ ☐ ☐
Listening while I play	☐ ☐ ☐



FOR TEACHERS

Unit 2 is where the vocabulary lands: loud, soft, fast, slow, high, low, pattern, beat, rest. Pupils who leave this unit using those nine words accurately can access everything in Units 3 to 5.

The ta and sh syllables are introduced here deliberately before any notation. Stick notation arrives in Unit 3 and will make immediate sense to pupils who have already chanted the patterns.

Topic 2.4 needs genuine quiet and is worth timetabling when the building is calm. It is the listening foundation for the soundscape work in Unit 3.

UNIT 3

The Long Bench

Music can travel, because it has a pulse that walks.

1 Music that goes somewhere

2 Walk to the pulse

3 Chanting along the way

4 Build a journey out of sound

5 Show us your journey



TOPIC 3.1

Music that goes somewhere



Otto and Hattie on the long bench with their eyes shut. Far off, painted very pale, a steam train crosses a viaduct.

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Otto put a piece of music on and asked everybody to shut their eyes and say where it was going.

Nutkin said a train. Hattie said somebody walking. Tessa said a boat. They were all right, because the music never said: it just kept moving, and moving is what made it feel like a journey.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ listen to music and say whether it is going somewhere
- ★ hear a steady beat underneath a tune
- ★ match a piece of music to a way of travelling

warm
up

Walk on the spot while your teacher plays. When the music stops, you stop. When it goes faster, you go faster. Do not look at anybody else, just listen.

TOPIC 3.1 • CONTINUED

In Topic 2.4 you listened to the world outside and sorted sounds into near and far. What made the far ones sound far away?

 MUSIC THAT GOES SOMEWHERE

Some music sits still. Some music travels, and you can feel it wanting to get somewhere before it arrives.

What makes it travel is a **steady beat that keeps coming**. Take the beat away and the same tune just floats.

 EVERY JOURNEY HAS ITS OWN BEAT

A person walking has a slow, even beat. A train has a fast, chugging one in little groups. A boat rocks. A horse has a beat you can hear the shape of, because its four feet do not land together.

Listen for the beat first, and the journey usually tells you what it is.



step



step



step



step

TOPIC 3.1 • CONTINUED



Wheels and rods, turning.



Tessa's footfalls, evenly spaced.

Music that travels

Music that sits still

YOUR TURN

Safe ears. Listening music is usually best a little quieter than you think. Turn it down and you hear more of what is underneath.

- 1** Shut your eyes while your teacher plays a piece of travelling music. Point your finger in a circle if you hear a steady beat.

VOICE OFF

- 2** Say what is travelling: a train, a walk, a boat, a horse or something else. There is no wrong answer, but say why you think so.

TOPIC 3.1 • CONTINUED

- 3 Move the way the music moves, all the way round the room.
Stop dead when it stops.

VOICE OFF

- 4 Listen to a second piece that does not travel. Say out loud what is different about it.

- 5 Tap the beat of the travelling music on your knees while it plays. Try to keep going right to the end without losing it.

 PIP'S TRUE THING

In one American cave, someone turned the stone icicles hanging from the roof into a giant instrument. Little rubber hammers tap the stones.

 ONE STEP MORE

Draw your journey as a line across the page while the music plays.
Bumpy for a bumpy piece, smooth for a smooth one.

TOPIC 3.1 • CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Listen to the same piece twice and count how many times the beat goes round in fours. Say the number at the end.

♪ Words from Topic 3.1

**journey**

going from here to
somewhere else

**beat**

the step of the music

**listen**

hear it on purpose

**travel**

to keep moving along



Five of them walking in a line, all left feet forward at the same moment, Bramble tapping once for every step.

TOPIC 3.2

Walk to the pulse

♪ ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Bramble walked the length of the bench tapping his drum once for every step. Then he asked Nutkin to do it, and Nutkin's taps and feet came apart immediately.

Bramble said the trick is not to think about your hands. Think about your feet, and let your hands copy them. It worked on the second try.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ find the pulse of a piece and walk to it
- ★ tell the pulse apart from the rhythm
- ★ say and clap ta and te-te
- ★ read a short pattern in stick notation

warm
up

Walk round the room. Your teacher claps a steady pulse and your feet land on the claps. Not near the claps: on them.

TOPIC 3.2 · CONTINUED

Otto asks: in Topic 2.3 you said *ta* for a sound and *sh* for a silence. What do you think two sounds in one step might be called?

 THE PULSE IS THE WALK

Underneath almost all music there is a steady pulse that never changes. It is the walking. You can nod to it, step to it or pat it on your knees.

Count it in fours: **1, 2, 3, 4**, and round again. The 1 always feels like the strongest one.

 THE RHYTHM SITS ON TOP

The **pulse** is the same all the way through. The **rhythm** is what the words and tune do on top of it, and that changes all the time.

Clap the pulse with one hand on your knee while you say a rhyme out loud. Two different things at once, which is exactly what musicians do.

TOPIC 3.2 • CONTINUED

 TWO SOUNDS IN ONE STEP: TE-TE

Sometimes you fit two little sounds into one step of the walk. We say **te-te**, and we write them joined together with a beam across the top.

Say **ta** and step. Say **te-te** and step once, but say two syllables while your foot is down. Your foot does not speed up.

 ONE SOUND OVER TWO STEPS: TA-A

The other way round: hold one sound while your feet take two steps. We say **ta-a** and hold it. The little tick after the stem tells you to keep going.

THE PULSE: FOUR EVEN STEPS

1

2

3

4

TOPIC 3.2 · CONTINUED

FOUR STEPS, ONE SOUND EACH

4

4



ta ta ta ta

NOW WITH A TE-TE IN STEP THREE

4

4



ta ta te te ta

A LONG SOUND FIRST: TA-A

4

4



ta a ta ta

TOPIC 3.2 · CONTINUED

THE TRAIN PATTERN

4

4



chuff a chuff a off we

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. Everybody stamping at once is very loud from underneath. Walk firmly, do not stamp, and the class below you will thank you.

- 1 Walk the pulse round the room, then stop and pat it on your knees without moving your feet. Same speed, no feet.

1, 2, 3, 4

VOICE OFF

- 2 Say the train pattern out loud while you walk the pulse: chuff-a chuff-a off we. Your feet stay on the four steps.

chuff a chuff a off we

- 3 Clap ta ta te-te ta four times without stopping. The te-te must fit inside one step.

ta ta te te ta

TOPIC 3.2 · CONTINUED

- 4 Half the class walks and pats the pulse. The other half claps the train pattern on top. Then swap.

VOICE OFF

- 5 Play the train pattern on a drum or a pair of claves while a partner walks the pulse beside you.

 PIP'S TRUE THING

Your heart is the drum you were born with, and it beats faster than a grown-up's. A six-year-old's heart can beat over 100 times a minute while a grown-up's beats about 70.

 ONE STEP MORE

Find your own pulse: two fingers on your neck, just under your jaw. Now walk fast for a minute and find it again. Faster?

 BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Say ta-a ta ta while you walk four steps, and hold the ta-a for two whole steps without letting it wobble.

TOPIC 3.2 • CONTINUED

🎵 Words from Topic 3.2

**pulse**

the steady walk
underneath

**rhythm**

what happens on top

**ta**

one sound in one step

**te-te**

two sounds in one step

**ta-a**

one sound held over
two steps

**heartbeat**

your own drum, going
all day

TOPIC 3.3

Chanting along the way

♪ ON THE LITTLE STAGE

They walked to the top of the hill and back, and they chanted all the way. Nobody got tired, which Hattie thought was strange, because it was a long way.

Otto explained it: a chant gives your feet something to hold on to. Soldiers, sailors and farm workers all knew that, which is why nearly every walking song in the world is about going somewhere.



Single file along the lane, chanting as they go. Nutkin swings a stick in time. Tessa brings up the rear.

TOPIC 3.3 • CONTINUED

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ chant a rhyme in time with your steps
- ★ sing a journey song with the right beat
- ★ keep going without speeding up
- ★ put actions in the same place every time

warm
up

Chant your own name in time with four steps, over and over. Then chant the name of the person next to you.

In Topic 3.2 you walked the pulse and clapped a rhythm on top. Which of those two do your feet do when you chant?

TOPIC 3.3 • CONTINUED

 A CHANT IS A RHYTHM WITH WORDS IN IT

You already know this. Every rhyme you have ever chanted in a playground has a beat, and everybody joins in on the same one without being told.

Here is one that is over two hundred years old, and it is about the most pointless journey ever made.

The Grand Old Duke of York

Oh, the grand old Duke of York,
He had ten thousand men,
He marched them up to the top of the hill,
And he marched them down again.

And when they were up they were up,
And when they were down they were down,
And when they were only halfway up,
They were neither up nor down.

TOPIC 3.3 · CONTINUED

🎵 UP AND DOWN, IN TIME

This one has actions built into the words, which is why it has survived so long: stand up on **up**, crouch down on **down**, and stop halfway on **halfway**.

Do them in exactly the same place every time. If everybody's actions come at the same moment, the whole class is keeping the same beat, and you can see it as well as hear it.

HOW THE FIRST LINE SITS ON THE BEAT

4

4



Oh the grand old Duke of



Four in single file, same foot forward.

FOUR STEPS, AND ROUND AGAIN

1

2

3

4

TOPIC 3.3 • CONTINUED

YOUR TURN

 **Safe ears.** Chanting outdoors carries a long way. Somewhere near you a class is probably reading quietly, so save the loudest chant for the field.

- 1 Learn The Grand Old Duke of York line by line, the way you learned Bobby Shaftoe in Topic 1.3.

SING IT

- 2 Now add the actions: up on up, down on down, and freeze on halfway. Same place every time.

- 3 Sing it while you walk in single file round the room. Your feet keep the pulse and your voice keeps the rhythm.

- 4 Chant Hickory, Dickory, Dock in time with four steps. Where does the beat land on the word dock?

- 5 Make up your own two-line chant about walking somewhere. Chant it four times without speeding up.

 PIP'S TRUE THING

An echo is your own voice coming back to you. The sound flies off, bumps into a wall or a cliff, and bounces home like a ball.

TOPIC 3.3 • CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Sing the Duke of York as a round in two halves, walking. The second half sets off when the first half reaches ten thousand men.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Chant the whole Duke of York while walking backwards. Slowly, and look where you are going.

♪ Words from Topic 3.3

**chant**

speaking in time, all together

**up**

the tune and your body both rise

**down**

the tune and your body both fall

**halfway**

not there yet, not back either

TOPIC 3.4

Build a journey out of sound



The stage arranged as a soundscape: a drum roll for thunder, a rainmaker, thin metal for wind, a bottle for a whistle.

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Badger said the class was going to build a journey out of nothing but sound, and that the audience would have to shut their eyes and guess where they had been taken.

Bramble started with rain, Nutkin did the wind, Hattie shook a sheet of thin metal for thunder and Tessa tapped a slow wood block for somebody walking through all of it. Otto guessed a storm on a hill, first go.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ choose instruments to stand for real things
- ★ put your sounds in an order that tells a story
- ★ start quiet, build up, and finish
- ★ play your part at the right moment and not before

TOPIC 3.4 · CONTINUED



One sound each, going round the circle, so that it sounds like rain starting: first one person, then two, then everybody, then back down to one.

In Topic 2.4 you copied a sound from outside with an instrument. Which instrument came closest?

🎵 **A SOUNDSCAPE IS A PICTURE MADE OF SOUND**

No tune, no words. Just sounds chosen so carefully that somebody with their eyes shut can tell where they are.

The choosing is the whole job. A shaker turned slowly is rain. Turned fast it is hail. A drum tapped with fingertips is footsteps; hit hard it is thunder. Same instruments, different choices.

🎵 **GIVE IT A BEGINNING, A MIDDLE AND AN END**

The commonest mistake is everybody playing everything all the time, which sounds like a cupboard falling over.

So: start with **one** sound. Add the others one at a time. Let it get to its loudest in the middle. Then take the sounds away again, one by one, until there is only one left. Then nothing.

TOPIC 3.4 · CONTINUED

- 1 Choose your place: a storm, a station, a river, a road at night.
- 2 Choose the four or five sounds that place really has.
- 3 Choose an instrument for each one, and test it.
- 4 Decide the order: who starts, who joins, who is last.
- 5 Practise the ending. Everybody stops, then everybody stays still.

Our place

Our sounds, in order

THE SHAPE OF A SOUNDSCAPE

 **one sound** the beginning **three sounds** building up **everybody** the middle **two sounds** going away **one sound** the end

TOPIC 3.4 • CONTINUED

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. Thunder is the loudest thing in most soundscapes, and it only works once. Save it for the middle and everybody's ears stay happy.

- 1 In groups of four or five, choose a place and write down its four sounds.

VOICE OFF

- 2 Choose an instrument for each sound and test it. If it does not sound like the real thing, choose a different one.

- 3 Decide the order and practise coming in one at a time. Nobody plays before their turn.

- 4 Practise the ending five times on its own: everybody stops, then everybody stays completely still.

- 5 Perform it to the class with their eyes shut. Ask them afterwards where they thought they were.

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

Very early on a spring morning, hundreds of birds sing all at once. The air is stillest then and the world is quiet, so their songs carry much further than they would later in the day.

TOPIC 3.4 • CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Add one sound made only with voices, no instrument. A whisper, a hum, a hiss. It usually turns out to be the best one.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Build a soundscape of a journey that changes halfway: it starts in one place and ends somewhere completely different.

🎵 Words from Topic 3.4

**soundscape**

a picture made of sound

**storm**

wind, rain and thunder together

**place**

somewhere your sounds take us

**order**

who plays first, and who is last



Three groups performing one after another. One group frozen mid-step, one holding instruments up, one waiting in the wings.

TOPIC 3.5

Show us your journey

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Three groups performed their journeys, one after another. The waiting groups sat behind the curtain and did not make a sound, which Badger said was the most professional thing he had ever seen them do.

Hattie's group went last. She counted them in herself, out loud, and nobody had to help her.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ perform your journey to an audience
- ★ wait quietly in the wings until it is your turn
- ★ count your own group in
- ★ say what you would change next time

TOPIC 3.5 • CONTINUED



Practise waiting. Sit behind the line for one whole minute in complete silence while another group plays. That is a real skill and it is harder than performing.

Otto asks: what are the four things in the little circle at the front of the book? Which one are you about to do?

🎵 WAITING IN THE WINGS

The wings are the bit of the stage the audience cannot see. It is where you wait, and the rule is simple: **nothing**. No talking, no practising, no jingling your instrument.

A sound from the wings goes straight to the audience and lands on top of somebody else's performance.

🎵 COUNTING YOUR OWN GROUP IN

You do not need a teacher to start you. One person in your group says **ready, steady, off we go** at exactly the speed of the piece, and everybody comes in on go.

Say it too fast and the piece will be too fast. The count-in is part of the music.

TOPIC 3.5 • CONTINUED



Waiting properly: still, and silent.



The bow at the end.

- 1 Wait in the wings. Nothing at all.
- 2 Walk on and stand still. Wait for the room to go quiet.
- 3 Count your group in, at the speed of the piece.
- 4 Play it. Listen to each other the whole way.
- 5 Stop together, stay still for one breath, then bow.

YOUR TURN

👉 **Safe ears.** In the audience, listen the way you would want to be listened to. Somebody up there is being brave.

TOPIC 3.5 • CONTINUED

- 1 Perform your soundscape from Topic 3.4 to the class. Count yourselves in with no help.

ready, steady, off we go

- 2 While another group performs, wait in the wings in complete silence. Do not practise your part.

VOICE OFF

- 3 As the audience, shut your eyes and listen. Afterwards say one thing you could really picture.

- 4 Take a proper bow at the end: stop, one breath of stillness, then bow together.

- 5 Say one thing your group would change if you did it again tomorrow.

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

Soldiers are often told to break step and walk normally when they cross a bridge. A whole column stamping the same beat can make a bridge wobble.

TOPIC 3.5 • CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Perform to a different class. The same piece will feel completely different in front of people you do not know.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Perform your soundscape with no count-in at all. One person breathes in loudly, and everybody starts on the breath.

♪ Words from Topic 3.5

**wings**

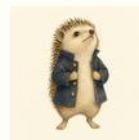
where you wait, out of sight

**audience**

the people listening

**count in**

how a group starts together

**perform**

give it to somebody

END OF UNIT 3

The Long Bench: what can you do?

Tick the ones you can do. If a box is empty, that is not a problem: it just tells you what to have another go at.

☐ I can hear whether a piece of music is going somewhere

☐ I can find the pulse and walk to it

☐ I can tell the pulse apart from the rhythm

☐ I can say and clap ta, te-te and ta-a

☐ I can read a short pattern in stick notation

☐ I can chant a rhyme in time with my steps

☐ I can choose instruments to stand for real things

☐ I can wait silently in the wings for my turn

☐ I can count my own group in



A journey needs a beat that keeps coming.

END OF UNIT 3 • CONTINUED

How did it go?

Colour one circle for each line. Green for yes, yellow for nearly, orange for not yet.

Walking the pulse without losing it	☐ ☐ ☐
Fitting te-te into one step	☐ ☐ ☐
Chanting and walking at the same time	☐ ☐ ☐
Choosing the right instrument for a sound	☐ ☐ ☐
Waiting in the wings	☐ ☐ ☐

 FOR TEACHERS

Unit 3 is the notation unit. Stick notation and the ta / te-te syllables arrive here, deliberately after a whole unit of chanting them in Topic 2.3, so the symbols describe something pupils can already do.

The pulse and rhythm distinction in Topic 3.2 is the single most transferable idea in the book. Pupils who can pat a steady pulse while saying a different rhythm have the foundation for all Key Stage 1 music. It usually takes several short sessions rather than one long one.

Every rhythm printed in this book is checked arithmetically before printing: each bar is proved to fill its time signature, and the syllables and the stick notation are generated from the same source, so they cannot disagree.

UNIT 4

The Platform

You can build a journey out of sound, and perform it.

1 Cars, planes and boats

2 A travelling song

3 Make a travel pattern

4 Put the pieces in order

5 Looking back at Unit 4



TOPIC 4.1

Cars, planes and boats



Nutkin whirring like a motor, Hattie sweeping a shaker like a passing car, Bramble rolling a drum, Otto hooting low.

♪ ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Badger dressed the stage as a railway platform: a bench, a lamp on a post, a leather trunk. Then he asked everybody to make the sound of something that travels, using only their mouths.

Nutkin's motorbike was so good that Tessa asked him to do it again. Then Otto did a ship's horn so low that everybody felt it in their chests.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ make a travel sound with your voice
- ★ find an instrument that makes nearly the same sound
- ★ say whether a travel sound is high or low, fast or slow
- ★ sort travel sounds by how they move

TOPIC 4.1 • CONTINUED



Engines round the circle. One person starts a low engine hum, and one by one everybody joins in until the whole room is one big engine. Then your teacher's hand comes down and it stops dead.

Otto asks: in Topic 2.2 you learned that big things make low sounds. So which is lower, a lorry or a bicycle bell?

🎵 THINGS THAT TRAVEL HAVE VERY GOOD SOUNDS

They have to. A car that made no noise at all would be dangerous, so engineers give vehicles sounds on purpose: horns, bells, whistles, sirens.

And they all move, which means their sound arrives, gets louder, passes you and goes away again. That shape is the most useful thing in this whole unit.

TOPIC 4.1 · CONTINUED

🎵 ARRIVING, PASSING, GOING

Every travel sound has three parts.

Arriving: quiet, and you are not quite sure yet.

Passing: loud, right in front of you, and only for a moment.

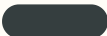
Going: quieter again, and lower than it was.

Make all three and anybody listening will know something went past.

THE SHAPE OF SOMETHING GOING PAST

 **arriving** quiet, far off

 **passing** loud, right here

 **going** quiet again, and lower



far



nearer



past you



away



gone

TOPIC 4.1 • CONTINUED



A steam engine.



A rowing boat.

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. Sirens and horns are loud in real life because they have to be. In here, make them small. A whole class of sirens at full volume is genuinely painful.

- 1** Choose one thing that travels and make its sound with your voice only. Do it three times and make it better each time.
VOICE OFF
- 2** Now do the arriving, passing and going shape with your voice: quiet, loud, quiet and lower.
- 3** Find an instrument that comes closest to your travel sound. Play the three-part shape on it.
- 4** Sort the travel sounds your class made into two trays: things that roll and things that float.

TOPIC 4.1 • CONTINUED

- 5 Shut your eyes while a partner makes a travel sound. Say what it is and whether it was arriving or going away.

VOICE OFF

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

When a train rushes past you, its whistle sounds high as it comes and suddenly drops low as it goes. The whistle never changes: it is the rushing past that changes what your ears hear.

► ONE STEP MORE

Listen to a real vehicle going past outside. Does its sound really drop as it passes, or does it just get quieter?

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Make a whole journey with your voice alone, in five sounds: start the engine, set off, go past, slow down, stop.

♪ Words from Topic 4.1

**engine**

the part that makes it go

**whistle**

a small high sound that carries far

**arrive**

it comes towards you

**pass**

it goes right by you



Everybody singing in a line, arms circling like wheels, one paw shading the eyes to look far ahead.

TOPIC 4.2

A travelling song

♪ ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Hattie asked whether they could sing the one about the bus. Badger said no, and then explained why, which was more interesting than the song.

Somebody wrote that song, quite recently, and the words still belong to them. So the class would sing a much older one instead, whose words belong to everybody now. Hattie thought that was fair.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ learn a travelling song with actions
- ★ keep the actions in the same place every time
- ★ row in time with a partner
- ★ sing it as a round

TOPIC 4.2 · CONTINUED



Sit facing a partner, hold hands, and rock backwards and forwards in time. Slowly. You are a boat, and the boat sets the beat.

In Topic 3.3 you sang while you walked. What was the hardest part of doing two things at once?

🎵 **ROW, ROW, ROW YOUR BOAT**

This one is about a hundred and seventy years old and it is one of the best beginner rounds ever written, because every line starts with something you can do with your arms.

Row, Row, Row Your Boat

Row, row, row your boat,
Gently down the stream,
Merrily, merrily, merrily, merrily,
Life is but a dream.

Just the one verse. The other verses you might know, about crocodiles, are much newer, so this book leaves them out.

TOPIC 4.2 · CONTINUED

♪ A SONG THAT TRAVELS NEEDS A ROWING BEAT

Pull on **row**, and pull again on the next **row**. Your arms are the pulse. The words fit on top.

Notice the first sound is a long one: **ro-ow** takes two steps. That is **ta-a**, the long sound you learned in Unit 3.

♪ SONGS WHOSE WORDS BELONG TO SOMEBODY

Some songs are very old, and their words belong to everybody. Some songs were written by a person who is still alive, or whose family is, and those words still belong to them.

This book only prints the old ones. The newer ones are lovely and you should sing them, but printing somebody's words without asking would not be fair.

HOW THE FIRST LINE ROWS

4

4

| _ | |

Ro ow row your

TOPIC 4.2 • CONTINUED



Oars mid stroke, ripples spreading evenly.

PULL ON ONE, PULL ON THREE

1

2

3

4

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. Rounds get loud quickly because everybody wants to be heard over the other half. Sing softer, not louder, and you will hear both halves properly.

- 1 Learn Row, Row, Row Your Boat line by line. One line, wait, sing it back.

SING IT

- 2 Sit facing a partner and row in time while you sing it. Your arms keep the pulse.

- 3 Sing it as a round in two halves. The second half starts when the first half reaches gently.

- 4 Sing Bobby Shaftoe again from Unit 1, and notice that it is a travelling song too. Where is he going?

TOPIC 4.2 • CONTINUED

- 5 Make up one action for each line of Row, Row, Row Your Boat that is not rowing. Agree them as a class.

SING IT

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

The little metal fork that musicians ping to find the right note was invented over 300 years ago by a trumpet player called John Shore.

► ONE STEP MORE

Sing it as a round in three groups instead of two. It works, but only if nobody speeds up.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Sing the whole round with your eyes shut, so you have to hold your own place by listening rather than watching.

♪ Words from Topic 4.2

**row**

pull the oars through
the water

**stream**

a little river, always
moving

**gently**

softly, and without
hurrying

**round**

the same song, started
at different times

TOPIC 4.3

Make a travel pattern

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Bramble laid four pebbles in a row on the boards and tapped them one at a time. Then he swapped two of them round and tapped again, and it was a different pattern.

That is composing. Not writing music down on paper: choosing what order the sounds come in, and being willing to change your mind.



Bramble and Hattie kneeling on the boards, arranging wooden cards and pebbles into a pattern, tapping each to test it.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ make up a four-beat travel pattern
- ★ write it down with pebbles, cards or sticks
- ★ play your own pattern the same way twice
- ★ change one thing and hear the difference

TOPIC 4.3 • CONTINUED



Say a travel word in a rhythm: **mo-tor-bike** is three sounds, **train** is one, **ae-ro-plane** is three. Clap each one.

In Topic 3.2 you learned ta, te-te and ta-a. Which of those is two sounds squeezed into one step?

🎵 YOUR WORDS ALREADY HAVE RHYTHMS IN THEM

Say **bi-cy-cle**. Three sounds, quick. Say **train**. One sound, long. You did not choose those rhythms, the words came with them.

So the easiest way to make a pattern is to pick travel words and put them in a row.

🎵 WRITING IT DOWN WITHOUT WRITING

Put one pebble for **ta**, two little pebbles close together for **te-te**, and a long stick for **ta-a**. Now your pattern exists outside your head and you can change it with your hands.

That is what composers do. Moving a pebble is much easier than remembering.

TOPIC 4.3 · CONTINUED

🎵 **CHANGE ONE THING AT A TIME**

Swap two pebbles round. Play it again. Better or worse? Now put them back and try something else.

If you change five things at once you will never know which one made the difference.

A TRAIN PATTERN

4

4



chuff a chuff a off we

A BOAT PATTERN

4

4



row row gent ly on

TOPIC 4.3 · CONTINUED

AN AEROPLANE GOING OVER

4

4



whoo oo oo sh

Our pattern in pebbles

Say it in ta and te-te

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. Testing a pattern means playing it many times over. Test quietly, and save the full volume for when you have chosen.

- 1 Choose three travel words and clap each one on its own. How many sounds does each word have?

VOICE OFF

- 2 Put your three words in a row to make one four-beat pattern. Say it out loud four times.

- 3 Lay your pattern out in pebbles or cards on the table, one for each sound.

TOPIC 4.3 · CONTINUED

- 4 Play your pattern on an instrument, exactly the same, three times running.
- 5 Now swap two pebbles round and play it again. Say out loud which version you prefer, and why.

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

Sound races through iron about thirteen times faster than through air. That is why a train's rumble reaches the rails long before the sound reaches you through the air.

► ONE STEP MORE

Give your pattern a long sound at the end, a ta-a-a held over three steps, so it feels like arriving.

TOPIC 4.3 • CONTINUED

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Make an eight-beat pattern out of two four-beat patterns, where the second half is the first half backwards.

🎵 Words from Topic 4.3

**compose**

to choose what order
the sounds come in

**pattern**

a row of sounds that
comes back

**order**

which sound comes first

**change**

try it a different way

TOPIC 4.4

Put the pieces in order



A performance in a clear order across the boards: Badger at the rope, then Pip singing, then Bramble drumming, then everybody.

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

*Everybody had a pattern and a song and a travel sound,
and when they all did them at once it was a mess.*

Badger wrote the order on a card and pinned it to the post. Pip first, then Bramble, then everybody, then quiet again. Exactly the same music, in an order, and suddenly it was a piece.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ put several pieces of music in an order
- ★ come in at the right moment and not before
- ★ follow a written running order
- ★ make a piece that has a beginning and an end

TOPIC 4.4 • CONTINUED



Four groups, four sounds. Your teacher points at one group at a time and only that group plays. Watch the pointing finger.

In Topic 3.4 your soundscape started with one sound and built up. What did that do for the audience?

🎵 A RUNNING ORDER IS THE WHOLE TRICK

A piece of music is not a pile of sounds. It is sounds **in an order**, and the order is a decision somebody makes.

Write it down. Four lines is plenty:

1 engine starts 2 we set off 3 everybody 4 we arrive

🎵 COMING IN ON TIME

You have one job: know what happens just before your bit, and listen for it. That is your cue.

Do not count silently and hope. Listen for the thing before you, then come in.

TOPIC 4.4 • CONTINUED

1 Somebody starts alone. One sound, quiet.

2 A second person joins. Now there are two.

3 Everybody comes in. This is the loudest part.

4 Take them away one at a time, until one is left.

5 The last sound stops. Nobody moves for one breath.

Our running order

EVERYBODY COUNTS THE SAME FOUR

1

2

3

4

TOPIC 4.4 • CONTINUED



Safe ears. The everybody part is the loudest moment in your piece. Make it shorter than you think it should be and it will sound better as well as feel kinder.

- 1 In groups, write your running order on the frame above. Four lines, and everybody's name on one of them.

VOICE OFF

- 2 Practise coming in one at a time. Say your cue out loud first: I come in after Hattie's shaker.

- 3 Run the whole piece through once without stopping, even if somebody goes wrong. Fix it afterwards, not during.

- 4 Practise the ending on its own five times: last sound, stillness, then relax.

- 5 Now perform it, with the running order pinned up where you can all see it.

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

Light travels much faster than sound, so you always see the lightning before you hear the thunder. Count the seconds in between: every three seconds means the storm is about a kilometre away.

TOPIC 4.4 • CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Swap your running order round: do the loud bit first and the quiet bit last. Which one sounds more like arriving?

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Perform your piece with the running order face down. You have to remember your cue and trust the person before you.

🎵 Words from Topic 4.4

**running order**

what happens, and
when

**cue**

the sound just before
your turn

**sequence**

one thing after another

**arrive**

the end of the journey



Sitting in a circle at the end of a session, talking it over. Instruments set down neatly. Otto has a wing raised.

TOPIC 4.5

Looking back at Unit 4

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

At the end of the unit everybody sat in a circle with the instruments in the middle, and Otto asked one question: what can you do now that you could not do at the start of the year?

It took a while. Hattie said she could stand at the front. Nutkin said he could wait for his turn, which made Tessa laugh, but he was right.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ say what you can do now
- ★ listen to somebody else's answer without interrupting
- ★ choose one thing to get better at
- ★ look after the instruments properly

TOPIC 4.5 • CONTINUED



Round the circle: everybody says one word about a sound they made this unit. One word each, no explaining, and nobody repeats a word.

Otto asks: which of the four things in the little circle do you find hardest? Listen, try, choose or show?

🎵 LOOKING BACK IS PART OF THE WORK

Musicians do this all the time. Not to find out who was best, but to find out what to practise next.

The useful question is never *was it good?* It is **what would I change?** Everybody has an answer to that one, including people who have been doing it for fifty years.

🎵 PUTTING THE CUPBOARD BACK PROPERLY

Every instrument goes back where it came from, the right way up, with its beater beside it. Skins face up, triangles hung by their cords, shakers standing.

Do that and they will still work next year for the class after you.

TOPIC 4.5 · CONTINUED

Something I can do now

Something to practise next



Look after your ears, and everybody else's.

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. One last time, because it matters: if a sound makes you want to move away from it, that is your ears being sensible. They are the only pair you get.

- 1 Fill in the two frames above. One thing you can do now, one thing to practise next.

VOICE OFF

- 2 Go round the circle and say your answer out loud. Everybody else listens without interrupting.

- 3 Choose your favourite of the three travel patterns from Topic 4.3 and play it one last time, properly.

- 4 Put every instrument back the right way: skins up, triangles hung by their cords, beaters beside their drums.

TOPIC 4.5 • CONTINUED

- 5 Say thank you to the person who was in your group. They listened to you all unit.

VOICE OFF

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

Sound goes more than four times faster through water than through air. Whales use that to send messages a very long way.

► ONE STEP MORE

Ask somebody at home which travelling song they sang when they were five. Learn it, and teach it to the class.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Teach your travel pattern to somebody who was not in your group, without playing it for them first. You have to say it in ta and te-te.

♪ Words from Topic 4.5

**tidy**

everything back where it belongs

**practise**

do it again to get better

**reflect**

think about how it went

**improve**

make it better than last time

END OF UNIT 4

The Platform: what can you do?

Tick the ones you can do. If a box is empty, that is not a problem: it just tells you what to have another go at.

- ☐ I can make a travel sound with my voice
- ☐ I can find an instrument that sounds nearly the same
- ☐ I can make something sound like it is arriving, passing and going
- ☐ I can sing a travelling song with actions
- ☐ I can sing a round without speeding up
- ☐ I can make up a four-beat pattern out of travel words
- ☐ I can write my pattern down with pebbles or cards
- ☐ I can follow a running order and come in on my cue
- ☐ I can put the instruments away properly



Everything packed, ready for the last unit.

END OF UNIT 4 • CONTINUED

How did it go?

Colour one circle for each line. Green for yes, yellow for nearly, orange for not yet.

Making the arriving, passing, going shape	☐ ☐ ☐
Singing a round in two halves	☐ ☐ ☐
Composing my own four-beat pattern	☐ ☐ ☐
Coming in on my cue	☐ ☐ ☐
Looking back honestly	☐ ☐ ☐

 FOR TEACHERS

Topic 4.2 carries a deliberate teaching moment about authorship. The obvious travel songs for this age (The Wheels on the Bus, Down by the Station) are still in copyright, so this book names them and prints Row, Row, Row Your Boat and Bobby Shaftoe instead, both of which are out of copyright. Pupils find the fairness argument easy to follow, and it is worth making rather than glossing over.

Topic 4.3 is composition proper, and the pebbles matter. Pupils who externalise a pattern with objects can revise it; pupils holding it in their heads can only repeat it.

Topic 4.4 is the rehearsal skill the final project in Unit 5 depends on. A written running order, pinned where everybody can see it, is the single most useful piece of equipment in the room.

UNIT 5

The Full Stage

Put it all together, and give it to an audience.

- 1 All our favourite songs
- 2 Add a drum, add a shake
- 3 Make our celebration piece
- 4 Rehearse it properly
- 5 The big show



TOPIC 5.1

All our favourite songs



All seven singing together with real delight, beaks and mouths wide, bunting going up above them.

♪ ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Badger climbed up and started stringing paper bunting between the posts, which is how everybody knew what time of year it was.

Pip said they should sing every single song they had learned, right through, in order. It took most of the afternoon and nobody wanted to stop.

TOPIC 5.1 • CONTINUED

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ sing the songs you learned this year from memory
- ★ choose which songs go in the show
- ★ sing in tune with everybody else
- ★ remember the actions without being told

A circular icon with the words "warm up" in white text on a dark orange background.

Your usual warm up, and by now you should not need telling. Yawn, stretch, slide your voice from high to low, hum one long note.

Otto asks: which song did you find hardest at the start of the year? Can you sing it now without looking?

TOPIC 5.1 • CONTINUED

 EVERYTHING YOU HAVE LEARNED TO SING

Here is the whole list. Every one of these is in your songbook at the back of the book, with its words, so you can find any of them again.

- **Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star**, from Unit 1
- **Frere Jacques**, from Unit 1
- **Oranges and Lemons**, from Unit 2
- **London's Burning**, from Unit 2
- **Old MacDonald Had a Farm**, from Unit 2
- **The Grand Old Duke of York**, from Unit 3
- **See Saw, Marjory Daw**, from Unit 3
- **Hickory, Dickory, Dock**, from Unit 3
- **Ride a Cock Horse to Banbury Cross**, from Unit 3
- **Row, Row, Row Your Boat**, from Unit 4
- **Bobby Shaftoe**, from Unit 4

All of them are very old, and all of their words belong to everybody now, which is why they could be printed for you.

TOPIC 5.1 • CONTINUED

🎵 CHOOSING WHAT GOES IN THE SHOW

A show is not everything you know. It is the best four or five things, in a good order, with a strong one at the end.

Vote. Sing the first line of each song, put your hands up for the ones you want, and count. That is a fair way to choose and it takes five minutes.

Our four chosen songs, in order



Everything you learned this year is in the songbook at the back.

YOUR TURN

🔊 Safe ears. A whole class singing at full volume for a whole afternoon is tiring for everybody's ears and voices. Sing some of it softly: it sounds better anyway.

TOPIC 5.1 • CONTINUED

- 1 Sing the first line of each song on the list. Put your hand up for the four you want in the show.

SING IT

- 2 Count the votes and write your four songs in order on the frame above. Save a good one for last.

- 3 Sing all four of your chosen songs straight through, in your order, without stopping in between.

- 4 Sing one of them entirely from memory with the book shut. All of you, no help.

- 5 Do the actions for one song without singing at all, and see whether the class can name it.

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

The oldest musical instruments anyone has found are little flutes carved from bird bone and mammoth ivory, discovered in a cave in Germany. They are over 40,000 years old.

TOPIC 5.1 • CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Sing your first chosen song as quietly as the whole class possibly can, and your last one properly. The quiet one will be the one people remember.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Sing one song as a round in two halves and keep both halves steady, with no conductor at all.

♪ Words from Topic 5.1

**celebration**

a day when we mark something

**bunting**

little flags on a string

**from memory**

with the book shut

**choose**

pick the best ones on purpose



Pip singing at the front while Bramble adds a drum, Nutkin a shaker and Tessa a slow wood block: three different parts at once.

TOPIC 5.2

Add a drum, add a shake

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Nutkin wanted to add a shaker to Pip's song, so he shook it as fast as he could all the way through. You could not hear Pip at all.

Tessa tried instead. She tapped a wood block once at the start of every line, and it made the song sound bigger without covering it up. Less turned out to be more, which Nutkin found annoying but accepted.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ add a percussion part to a song you know
- ★ play a part without drowning the singers
- ★ keep your own part going while others play a different one
- ★ choose a part that suits the song

TOPIC 5.2 · CONTINUED



Everybody pats the pulse on their knees while one person sings a line alone. The pats must be quieter than the singer. That is the whole lesson.

In Topic 3.2 you kept a pulse going while somebody else did a rhythm. What made that hard?

🎵 **A PART IS NOT THE WHOLE SONG**

When you add percussion to a song, the song is still the important thing. Your part is there to hold it up, not to sit on top of it.

The test is simple: if you cannot hear the words, you are too loud, and it does not matter how good your part is.

TOPIC 5.2 · CONTINUED

 FOUR PARTS THAT ALWAYS WORK

The pulse. One steady sound on every step. Safe, and it holds everybody together.

Every other one. Sound, gap, sound, gap. Sounds clever and is easy.

The busy one. Two sounds per step, all the way through. Use a quiet instrument for this or it takes over.

The long one. One sound held right across four steps. A cymbal or a triangle at the start of a line.

 CHOOSE THE PART THAT SUITS THE SONG

A slow, gentle song wants the long one. A marching song wants the pulse. A funny fast song can take the busy one.

Try all four against your song before you choose. It takes two minutes and it is the difference between a part and a nuisance.

TOPIC 5.2 · CONTINUED

PART ONE: THE PULSE

4

4



ta ta ta ta

PART TWO: EVERY OTHER ONE

4

4



ta sh ta sh

PART THREE: THE BUSY ONE, QUIETLY

4

4



te te te te te te te te

TOPIC 5.2 · CONTINUED

PART FOUR: ONE LONG SOUND, HELD

4

4

| _ _ _

ta a a a

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. Percussion behind a singer should be quieter than you think. If the singer has to push to be heard, their voice will tire and yours is the reason.

- 1 Choose one of your four songs. Half the class sings while the other half pats the pulse, quietly.

SING IT

- 2 Try each of the four parts above against your song, one at a time. Say out loud which one suits it best.

- 3 Add two parts at once: the pulse on a drum and the long one on a triangle. Sing over the top of both.

- 4 Play your part while somebody sings a line alone. If you cannot hear the words, play softer and try again.

TOPIC 5.2 • CONTINUED

- 5 Now do it with no instruments at all: pats for the pulse, clicks for every other one, and voices for the song.

SING IT

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

Before a concert, the whole orchestra tunes up to one note played by the oboe. Its sound is so clear that every single player can pick it out.

► ONE STEP MORE

Give a different part to each group and play all four at once underneath one song. It is a real arrangement.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Keep the busy part going, two sounds per step, for a whole song without speeding up. Much harder than it sounds.

♪ Words from Topic 5.2

**part**

your own job inside the music

**accompany**

play along with a singer

**hold**

let one sound ring on

**less**

sometimes the smaller part is better

TOPIC 5.3

Make our celebration piece

🎵 ON THE LITTLE STAGE

Badger put a long strip of paper on the table and said: this is our piece, from the first sound to the last. Now fill it in.

It took three goes. The first plan had everybody playing at once from the beginning. The second had no ending. The third one worked, and it was theirs.



Gathered round a low table on the boards, planning. Instruments laid out in a chosen order, pebbles in a row as a plan, Badger pointing at the first one.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ make one piece of music as a whole class
- ★ give the piece a beginning, a middle and an end
- ★ give everybody a job in it
- ★ write the plan down so everybody can see it

warm
up

One sound each, round the circle, as fast as it can go without a gap. Then again, but leave one silent beat between each person.

TOPIC 5.3 • CONTINUED

In Topic 4.4 you followed a running order. What went wrong when you did not have one?

🎵 YOUR CELEBRATION PIECE

One piece, the whole class, about three minutes. It should have your chosen songs in it, at least one pattern you composed, and one soundscape moment.

It should also have a quiet bit. A piece that is loud from beginning to end is exhausting to listen to, and the quiet bit is what makes the loud ending land.

🎵 THE SHAPE THAT ALWAYS WORKS

One sound. Somebody alone. A triangle, a bell, one voice.

The first song. Everybody, with one percussion part.

The middle. Your pattern, or your soundscape. This is the surprise.

The quiet bit. Nearly nothing. Two people at most.

The last song. Everybody, everything, the best one you have.

Silence. Then the bow.

TOPIC 5.3 • CONTINUED

 EVERYBODY HAS A JOB

Not everybody sings the solo, but nobody has nothing to do. Singers, players, the person who starts it, the person who gives the signal to stop, the person who counts everybody in.

Write the jobs down next to the names. Then nobody is standing there wondering.

1 One sound, alone, to open it.

2 The first song, with one percussion part underneath.

3 The middle: your own pattern or soundscape.

4 The quiet bit. Two people at most.

5 The last song, everybody, and then silence.

Our plan, from first sound to last

TOPIC 5.3 • CONTINUED

Who does what

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. Plan your quiet bit properly. It is the part that protects everybody's ears and it is also the part that makes your ending sound big.

- 1 As a class, decide the one sound that opens your piece, and who makes it.
- 2 Fill in the plan frame above, using the five-part shape. One line for each part.
VOICE OFF
- 3 Fill in the jobs frame. Everybody's name goes on it somewhere.
- 4 Play the piece straight through once, following the plan, even if it goes wrong. You are finding out where the problems are.
SING IT
- 5 Change one thing about the plan and play it again. Say whether it was better.

TOPIC 5.3 • CONTINUED

♪ PIP'S TRUE THING

One of the largest musical instruments in the world is an organ with over 33,000 pipes. Its smallest pipe is shorter than your finger and its largest is taller than a house.

► ONE STEP MORE

Give your piece a name. A real one, that says something about it, not just Our Piece.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Make the quiet bit last twice as long as feels comfortable. Count eight slow beats of nearly nothing. Audiences love it.

♪ Words from Topic 5.3

**plan**

what happens, written down

**job**

the thing you are looking after

**quiet bit**

nearly nothing, on purpose

**piece**

one whole thing you made

TOPIC 5.4

Rehearse it properly



A rehearsal not quite right yet: Badger's paw is up to stop everyone, Nutkin has come in too early, the others are waiting. Good-humoured.

♪ ON THE LITTLE STAGE

The first full rehearsal went wrong four times in the same place: Nutkin came in before the quiet bit had finished.

Hattie, who could not stand at the front in the autumn, said they should practise just that one join, ten times, and nothing else. They did, and it never went wrong again. Rehearsing is not playing it through: it is fixing the joins.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ rehearse one difficult join over and over
- ★ come in on your cue without being told
- ★ keep going when somebody else makes a mistake
- ★ say what still needs work, kindly

TOPIC 5.4 • CONTINUED



Practise one join only: the last two beats of the quiet bit and the first two of the last song. Just those four beats, five times.

Otto asks: what is the difference between playing your piece through and rehearsing it?

🎵 **REHEARSING MEANS FIXING THE JOINS**

Playing the whole thing through from the beginning again and again is the slowest way to get better, because you spend most of the time on the bits that already work.

Find the place it goes wrong. Practise the four beats before it and the four beats after it, ten times. Then put it back in the piece.

🎵 **IF SOMEBODY GOES WRONG, KEEP GOING**

In a rehearsal you stop and fix it. In a performance you do not: you keep going, and almost nobody in the audience notices.

The only thing that turns a small mistake into a big one is everybody stopping to look at it.

TOPIC 5.4 • CONTINUED

🎵 HOW TO SAY WHAT NEEDS WORK

Say the **place**, not the person. Not *Nutkin came in early* but *the join into the last song needs practising*.

It is the same information and it is much easier to hear. Real musicians talk like this to each other all the time.

1 Play it through once. Do not stop, whatever happens.

2 Agree the one place that needs the most work.

3 Practise the four beats either side of that place, ten times.

4 Put it back in and play from a little before it.

5 Play the whole piece again. One thing will be better.

The join we practised today

What is better now

TOPIC 5.4 • CONTINUED

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. A long rehearsal is where ears get tired. Take the instruments out of your hands for the talking bits, and everybody stays fresher.

- 1 Play the whole piece through once without stopping, even if it goes wrong.

SING IT

- 2 As a class, agree the one place that needs the most work. Name the place, not a person.

VOICE OFF

- 3 Practise just that join ten times. Four beats before, four beats after, nothing else.

- 4 Play the piece again from a little before the join, and carry on to the end.

- 5 Write on the frame above which join you fixed and what is better now.

PIP'S TRUE THING

A Greek theatre built over 2,000 years ago lets 14,000 people hear an actor with no microphone at all. Scientists found the secret is the rows of stone seats, which quietly soak up the rumble of the crowd.

TOPIC 5.4 • CONTINUED

► ONE STEP MORE

Rehearse with your eyes on the conductor rather than on the page.
You will find you know it better than you thought.

★ BADGER'S CHALLENGE

Rehearse the whole piece with no talking at all between the sections. Signals only.

♪ Words from Topic 5.4

**rehearse**

practise the hard bits,
not all of it

**join**

where one part meets
the next

**keep going**

do not stop for a small
mistake

**kindly**

name the place, not the
person



The final show at dusk. All seven bowing together under glowing lanterns and paper bunting, a crowd of hedgerow animals applauding below.

TOPIC 5.5

The big show

♪ ON THE LITTLE STAGE

The lanterns were lit, the bunting was up, and there were more animals in front of the stage than anybody expected.

Hattie counted them in. Not Badger, not Pip: Hattie, who in the autumn would not stand at the front at all. She said *ready, steady, off we go*, and the whole hedgerow heard what they had made.

★ BY THE END YOU WILL

- ★ perform your celebration piece to a real audience
- ★ do your own job in it, all the way through
- ★ keep going if something goes wrong
- ★ take a bow properly
- ★ say one true thing about your year

TOPIC 5.5 • CONTINUED



The whole warm up, in order, exactly as you have done it all year. Then one slow breath in together, and out together. Then wait.

Otto asks, for the last time: listen, try, choose, show. You have done the first three all year. Today is the fourth.

🎵 **TODAY IS THE SHOW**

Everything in this book has been leading here. You know your songs, you know your part, you know your cue, and you know how to end.

One last thing, and it is the most important: the audience wants you to be good. Nobody came to catch you out. They came because they want to hear it.

🎵 **IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG**

It might. Somebody will come in early, or a triangle will get dropped. **Keep going.** Find the pulse, come back in, and carry on.

An audience remembers how a piece ended, not one wrong note in the middle.

TOPIC 5.5 • CONTINUED



One lantern, lit, waiting for the show.

★ THE BIG SHOW

What you are giving them. One piece, about three minutes, made by your whole class: your chosen songs, your own pattern, your soundscape moment, one quiet bit and a proper ending.

The running order. Pinned up where everybody can see it, exactly as you rehearsed it in Topic 5.4.

Everybody's job. Singers, players, the person who makes the first sound, the person who counts you in, the person who gives the signal to stop. Nobody is standing there with nothing to do.

TOPIC 5.5 • CONTINUED

★ WHAT A GOOD SHOW MEANS HERE

How you will know it went well. Tick these together after the show. Notice that none of them is about being perfect.

- ☐ we started together, on our own count-in
- ☐ everybody did their own job all the way through
- ☐ you could hear the words of every song
- ☐ our quiet bit was really quiet
- ☐ we kept going when something went wrong
- ☐ we stopped together, stayed still, then bowed



Bunting goes up for the big show.



Stop. One breath of stillness. Then bow, together.

TOPIC 5.5 • CONTINUED

YOUR TURN



Safe ears. One last time: look after your ears, and everybody else's. You have a whole lifetime of music ahead of you and you will want to hear all of it.

- 1 Perform your celebration piece to your audience, from the first sound to the silence at the end.

ready, steady, off we go

SING IT

- 2 Do your own job all the way through, even the waiting parts. Especially the waiting parts.

- 3 If something goes wrong, keep going. Find the pulse and come back in.

- 4 Stop together at the end. Stay still for one breath. Then bow, all of you at once.

VOICE OFF

- 5 Afterwards, tick the list in the box above as a class. Be honest: an empty box just tells you what to work on next year.

TOPIC 5.5 • CONTINUED

- 6** Say one thing you can do now that you could not do at the start of the year. Out loud, to somebody.

VOICE OFF

♪ **PIP'S TRUE THING**

In ancient Greece only a few actors played all the parts. They swapped masks to become a new character in a moment, and the big painted faces helped people right at the back see who was who.

► **ONE STEP MORE**

Perform it again to another class, or to the whole school. It will be better the second time, because you will not be frightened.

★ **BADGER'S CHALLENGE**

Be the person who counts the whole class in. In front of everybody. Like Hattie.

♪ Words from Topic 5.5



show

the day you give it away



company

everybody who made it with you



applause

how an audience says thank you



proud

the feeling at the end of a show

END OF UNIT 5

The Full Stage: what can you do?

Tick the ones you can do. If a box is empty, that is not a problem: it just tells you what to have another go at.

- ☐ I can sing the songs I learned this year from memory
- ☐ I can add a percussion part without covering up the singers
- ☐ I can help plan a piece with a beginning, a middle and an end
- ☐ I can do my own job inside a class piece
- ☐ I can rehearse one difficult join over and over
- ☐ I can keep going when something goes wrong
- ☐ I can perform to a real audience
- ☐ I can take a bow properly
- ☐ I can say what I would change next time



The end of the year, on the full stage.

END OF UNIT 5 • CONTINUED

How did it go?

Colour one circle for each line. Green for yes, yellow for nearly, orange for not yet.

Singing from memory	☐ ☐ ☐
Playing a part quietly enough	☐ ☐ ☐
Doing my job all the way through	☐ ☐ ☐
Keeping going when it went wrong	☐ ☐ ☐
Performing to an audience	☐ ☐ ☐



FOR TEACHERS

Topic 5.5 is the final project and its success criteria are published to the pupils in the box on that page, so they know before they start what a good performance means here: together, audible, everybody working, a real quiet moment, and a clean ending. Polish is deliberately not on the list.

Hattie's arc completes in this unit. She is too shy to stand at the front in Topic 1.5 and she counts the whole class in at the final show. It is worth pointing out to pupils who found the autumn hard.

Every song revised here is printed in full in the songbook at the back of the book, with its provenance, so a pupil can find any of them again and a teacher can see why these particular songs were chosen.

OUR SONGBOOK

Every song you learned this year

Here they all are, with their words, so you can find any of them again whenever you want to sing.

Every song in this songbook is very old. Somebody made each one up a long time ago and then everybody sang it, and passed it on, and now the words belong to all of us. That is why they could be printed for you here.

Under each song is a line telling you where its words were first written down, and how long ago that was. Some of them are older than your school, your town, and possibly your country.



The songbook, open on the bench.

OUR SONGBOOK • UNIT 1

The Green Room



Your own voice: the first instrument you ever had.

Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star

Twinkle, twinkle, little star,
How I wonder what you are!
Up above the world so high,
Like a diamond in the sky.

OUR SONGBOOK · UNIT 1 · CONTINUED

English words, French tune. First written down in 1806. Words by Jane Taylor, published in *Rhymes for the Nursery*, 1806. The tune is the French *Ah! vous dirai-je, maman*, 1761. First verse only, which is the whole of Taylor's opening stanza.



A small light in the dark.

Frere Jacques

Frere Jacques, Frere Jacques,
Dormez-vous? Dormez-vous?
Sonnez les matines, sonnez les matines,
Ding, dang, dong. Ding, dang, dong.

French traditional. First written down in 1780. Anonymous traditional. Melody in a manuscript of c.1780 as *Frere Blaise*; words and music together, Paris, 1869. FRENCH, not British: the book says so rather than calling it a British song.

OUR SONGBOOK • UNIT 2

The Sound Cupboard



A tambourine: shake it or tap it, both work.

Oranges and Lemons

Oranges and lemons,
Say the bells of St Clement's.
You owe me five farthings,
Say the bells of St Martin's.

English traditional. First written down in c.1744. Anonymous traditional, Roud 13190. Tommy Thumb's Pretty Song Book, c.1744. Opening couplets only: a Year 1 class sings the first pair of bells and passes under the arch.



The bells of old London.

OUR SONGBOOK · UNIT 2 · CONTINUED

London's Burning

London's burning, London's burning,
Fetch the engines, fetch the engines,
Fire! Fire! Fire! Fire!
Pour on water, pour on water.

English traditional. First written down in before 1800. Anonymous traditional round. NOTE: the 1580 date often quoted attaches to the round's musical notation as Scotland's Burning, not to this wording, so the book does not claim 1580 for the words.



Handbells: the bells of old London.

Old MacDonald Had a Farm

Old MacDonald had a farm,
E, I, E, I, O!
And on that farm he had a duck,
E, I, E, I, O!

English, later Anglo-American. First written down in 1719. Roud 745. Descends from Thomas d'Urfey's In the Fields in Frost and Snow, printed in Wit and Mirth, 1719; the E-I-E-I-O form standardised by the 1920s. OUR OWN animal list and layout, so no modern arranger's verse set is reproduced.

OUR SONGBOOK • UNIT 3

The Long Bench



Footfalls, evenly spaced. That is a pulse.

The Grand Old Duke of York

Oh, the grand old Duke of York,
He had ten thousand men,
He marched them up to the top of the hill,
And he marched them down again.

And when they were up they were up,
And when they were down they were down,
And when they were only halfway up,
They were neither up nor down.

English traditional. First written down in 1913. Anonymous traditional. The modern wording reaches print in Arthur Rackham's *Mother Goose*, 1913. Actions are ours, not lifted from a modern songbook.

OUR SONGBOOK · UNIT 3 · CONTINUED



Up to the top of the hill, and down again.

See Saw, Marjory Daw

See saw, Marjory Daw,
Jacky shall have a new master,
He shall have but a penny a day,
Because he can't work any faster.

English traditional. First written down in c.1765. Anonymous traditional, Roud 13028. Mother Goose's Melody, London, c.1765. Related see-saw fragments run back to c.1640.



Hickory, dickory, dock.

OUR SONGBOOK · UNIT 3 · CONTINUED

Hickory, Dickory, Dock

Hickory, dickory, dock,
The mouse ran up the clock,
The clock struck one,
The mouse ran down,
Hickory, dickory, dock.

English traditional. First written down in 1744. Anonymous traditional, Roud 6489. Tommy Thumb's Pretty Song Book, 1744, as Hickere Dickere Dock.



Footfalls, evenly spaced. That is a pulse.

Ride a Cock Horse to Banbury Cross

Ride a cock horse to Banbury Cross,
To see a fine lady upon a white horse,
With rings on her fingers and bells on her toes,
She shall have music wherever she goes.

English, Oxfordshire. First written down in 1784. Anonymous traditional. A variant appears in Tommy Thumb's Pretty Song Book, c.1744; the modern wording in Gammer Gurton's Garland, 1784.

OUR SONGBOOK • UNIT 4

The Platform



A rowing boat, gently down the stream.

Row, Row, Row Your Boat

Row, row, row your boat,
Gently down the stream,
Merrily, merrily, merrily, merrily,
Life is but a dream.

OUR SONGBOOK • UNIT 4 • CONTINUED

American. First written down in 1852. FIRST VERSE ONLY. The 1852 words with the 1881 tune are clear. The familiar extra verses about crocodiles are modern street and commercial variants with no public-domain provenance, so they are not printed.



Gently down the stream.

Bobby Shaftoe

Bobby Shaftoe's gone to sea,
Silver buckles on his knee,
He'll come back and marry me,
Bonny Bobby Shaftoe.

English, North East. First written down in 1805. Earliest printed version 1805; further verses in John Bell, *Rhymes of Northern Bards*, 1812. Tune from the Henry Atkinson manuscript, 1690s.

FOR TEACHERS

Songs we sing but do not print

This book prints a song's words only when those words are out of copyright. The songs below are ones a Year 1 class may well sing, and several are named in the units, but their words still belong to the people who wrote them or to their families. So this book names them and prints nothing.

That is a deliberate editorial position rather than an oversight. It also turns out to be a good lesson: pupils in Topic 4.2 find the fairness argument easy to follow, and it is worth making rather than glossing over.

FOR TEACHERS • CONTINUED

- **The Wheels on the Bus.** First published Verna Hills, 1937. A named 20th-century author, first published in *American Childhood*, 1937. Well inside copyright. Unit 4 uses a traditional railway song instead. American, not British traditional.
- **Down by the Station.** First published Paul Mills and Slim Gaillard, 1947. THE HARD STOP. The melody is folk-like, but the words everyone sings are the 1947 text credited to named authors. Gaillard died in 1991, so the UK term runs to roughly 2061. Unit 4 uses the tune for a listening and rhythm task only, with our own words where words are needed.
- **If You're Happy and You Know It.** First published earliest trace 1957; US copyright filed 1971. HIGHEST RISK on the list. Wholly 20th century, and a live registered claim exists: Jonico Music filed in 1971 crediting Joe Raposo. Scholars agree he did not write it, but a registration is a registration. Not printed, not quoted, not paraphrased.
- **A Sailor Went to Sea.** First published collected 1972, published 1985. The clapping game and tune are traditional, but the only documented text is 20th century, gathered by Iona and Peter Opie and published in *The Singing Game*, 1985. Two exposures: the anonymous-work term, and the Opies' editorial copyright in their transcription.
- **This Old Man.** First published 1906 text PD; the modern text is not. SPLIT CASE. The 1906 Sharp and Baring-Gould text is public domain. The standard modern lyric derives from Anne Gilchrist's 1937 collection and was popularised by Malcolm Arnold's copyrighted 1958 arrangement. Since the modern words are the ones a class would expect, the book names the song and prints nothing.
- **Five Little Ducks.** First published no pre-20th-century print found. Authorship completely undocumented and the familiar version is the Raffi recording of 1982. Unclear authorship plus 20th century means it is treated as in copyright.
- **The Train Is A-Coming.** First published antecedent 1872; the children's text is modern. The underlying spiritual tradition is pre-1872 and public domain, but the specific children's lyric in circulation is a 20th-century arrangement with no traceable first printing.
- **The Big Ship Sails on the Alley Alley O.** First published British traditional, earliest print NOT CONFIRMED. Almost certainly public domain, but a specific pre-1930 printed source was NOT confirmed. The honest position is to withhold it pending one check against Alice Gomme, *The Traditional Games of England, Scotland and Ireland*, 1894 to 1898, or the Roud index. It is named, not printed, so nothing has to be recalled if the check comes back badly.

FOR TEACHERS • CONTINUED

Where a song is widely believed to be traditional but has a traceable author, that is recorded above. Two of these are the obvious travel songs for Year 1, which is precisely why the note matters.



A song sheet. Somebody wrote every one of these.

WORDS FROM THE THEATRE

All the words you learned

Every word from every unit, in alphabetical order, with a picture and what it means. There are 94 of them, which is a lot for one year.

The small grey number tells you which topic you first met the word in, so you can go back and look at it on the page where it was used.



The instruments of the Hedgerow Theatre, laid out for putting away.

WORDS FROM THE THEATRE • ACCOMPANY TO BEAT

**accompany**

play along with a singer
Topic 5.2

**action**

a movement that helps
you remember
Topic 1.3

**answer**

you sing back afterwards
Topic 1.4

**applause**

how an audience says
thank you
Topic 5.5

**arrive**

it comes towards you
Topic 4.1

**audience**

the people who are
listening
Topic 1.5

**band**

people playing at the
same time
Topic 2.5

**beat**

one step of the music
Topic 2.3

WORDS FROM THE THEATRE • BUNTING TO CLAP

**bunting**

little flags on a string
Topic 5.1

**by heart**

you can do it with the
book shut
Topic 1.3

**call**

you sing first
Topic 1.4

**celebration**

a day when we mark
something
Topic 5.1

**change**

try it a different way
Topic 4.3

**chant**

speaking in time, all
together
Topic 3.3

**choose**

pick the best ones on
purpose
Topic 5.1

**clap**

how we say thank you
Topic 1.5

WORDS FROM THE THEATRE • COMPANY TO ENGINE

**company**

everybody who made it
with you
Topic 5.5

**compose**

to choose what order the
sounds come in
Topic 4.3

**conductor**

the one who starts and
stops you
Topic 2.5

**copy**

do exactly what you
heard
Topic 1.3

**count in**

how a group starts
together
Topic 3.5

**cue**

the sound just before
your turn
Topic 4.4

**down**

the tune and your body
both fall
Topic 3.3

**engine**

the part that makes it go
Topic 4.1

WORDS FROM THE THEATRE • FAR TO HIGH

**far**

soft and smudged
Topic 2.4

**fast**

the sounds come often
Topic 2.2

**from memory**

with the book shut
Topic 5.1

**gap**

the silence in between
Topic 1.4

**gently**

softly, and without
hurrying
Topic 4.2

**halfway**

not there yet, not back
either
Topic 3.3

**heartbeat**

your own drum, going all
day
Topic 3.2

**high**

a fast wobble
Topic 1.1

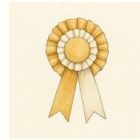
WORDS FROM THE THEATRE • HOLD TO KEEP GOING

**hold**

let one sound ring on
Topic 5.2

**hum**

singing with your mouth
closed
Topic 1.2

**improve**

make it better than last
time
Topic 4.5

**instrument**

a thing made for making
music
Topic 2.1

**job**

the thing you are looking
after
Topic 5.3

**join**

where one part meets
the next
Topic 5.4

**journey**

going from here to
somewhere else
Topic 3.1

**keep going**

do not stop for a small
mistake
Topic 5.4

WORDS FROM THE THEATRE • KINDLY TO ORDER

**kindly**

name the place, not the
person
Topic 5.4

**less**

sometimes the smaller
part is better
Topic 5.2

**line**

one row of a song
Topic 1.3

**listen**

the first job of all
Topic 1.1

**loud**

a big sound
Topic 2.2

**low**

a slow wobble
Topic 1.1

**near**

clear, with edges
Topic 2.4

**order**

who plays first, and who
is last
Topic 3.4

WORDS FROM THE THEATRE • PART TO PRACTISE

**part**

your own job inside the
music
Topic 5.2

**pass**

it goes right by you
Topic 4.1

**pattern**

it comes back the same
Topic 2.3

**perform**

to give it to somebody
Topic 1.5

**piece**

one whole thing you
made
Topic 5.3

**place**

somewhere your sounds
take us
Topic 3.4

**plan**

what happens, written
down
Topic 5.3

**practise**

do it again to get better
Topic 4.5

WORDS FROM THE THEATRE • PROUD TO RHYTHM

**proud**

the feeling at the end of
a show
Topic 5.5

**pulse**

the steady walk
underneath
Topic 3.2

**quiet bit**

nearly nothing, on
purpose
Topic 5.3

**reflect**

think about how it went
Topic 4.5

**rehearse**

practise the hard bits,
not all of it
Topic 5.4

**repeat**

do it again the same way
Topic 2.3

**rest**

a beat where you play
nothing
Topic 2.3

**rhythm**

what happens on top
Topic 3.2

WORDS FROM THE THEATRE • ROUND TO SIGNAL

**round**

the same song, started
at different times
Topic 4.2

**row**

pull the oars through the
water
Topic 4.2

**running order**

what happens, and when
Topic 4.4

**scrape**

drag across the ridges
Topic 2.1

**sequence**

one thing after another
Topic 4.4

**shake**

loose bits knock about
Topic 2.1

**show**

the day you give it away
Topic 5.5

**signal**

a sign that means go, or
stop
Topic 2.5

WORDS FROM THE THEATRE • SING TO START

**sing**

your singing voice
Topic 1.1

**slow**

the sounds come rarely
Topic 2.2

**soft**

a little sound
Topic 2.2

**song**

words and a tune
together
Topic 1.2

**sound**

anything your ears can
catch
Topic 2.4

**soundscape**

a picture made of sound
Topic 3.4

**stage**

the place you stand to
perform
Topic 1.5

**start**

everybody at the same
moment
Topic 1.2

WORDS FROM THE THEATRE • STORM TO TOGETHER

**storm**

wind, rain and thunder
together
Topic 3.4

**stream**

a little river, always
moving
Topic 4.2

**ta**

one sound in one step
Topic 3.2

**ta-a**

one sound held over two
steps
Topic 3.2

**tap**

hit it and it rings
Topic 2.1

**te-te**

two sounds in one step
Topic 3.2

**tidy**

everything back where it
belongs
Topic 4.5

**together**

at the same moment
Topic 2.5

WORDS FROM THE THEATRE • TRAVEL TO WINGS

**travel**

to keep moving along
Topic 3.1

**tune**

the shape a song makes
Topic 1.2

**turn**

your moment, and
nobody else's
Topic 1.4

**up**

the tune and your body
both rise
Topic 3.3

**whistle**

a small high sound that
carries far
Topic 4.1

**wings**

where you wait, out of
sight
Topic 3.5

WHERE OUR FACTS CAME FROM

How do we know all that?

Every "Pip's true thing" in this book is really true. Before any of them was printed, a grown-up went and checked it in a book or on a website belonging to people whose job is knowing about it: museums, universities, bird societies and encyclopaedias.

Some things that everybody says turned out not to be quite right, so those were left out of the book altogether, even though they would have been fun.

You can do this too. When somebody tells you something amazing, the useful question is not whether it sounds true. It is: *how do you know?*



Pip checks before he tells you.

WHERE OUR FACTS CAME FROM · THE LIST

Unit 1: The Green Room

- **Inside your throat are two small stretchy bands called vocal folds. When you speak they snap together and buzz as air rushes past them from your lungs.**
Checked against <https://www.nidcd.nih.gov/health/taking-care-your-voice>
- **Your vocal folds are only a few millimetres long. Small bands wobble faster than big ones, and faster wobbles make higher sounds, which is why your voice is higher than a grown-up's.**
Checked against <https://ncvs.org/tutorials/voice-changes-throughout-life>
- **Children have much smaller lungs than grown-ups, yet you can shout just as loudly. You push the air out with more pressure to make up for being smaller.**
Checked against <https://ncvs.org/tutorials/voice-changes-throughout-life>
- **No two people's voices are exactly the same. The shape of your throat, the roof of your mouth and your vocal folds all belong only to you, so your friends know it is you before they turn round.**
Checked against <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6425070>
- **Robins sometimes sing right through the night. Street lights fool them into thinking that morning has come.**
Checked against <https://www.rspb.org.uk/birds-and-wildlife/robin>
- **High up inside the dome of St Paul's Cathedral in London you can whisper against the curved wall, and a friend on the far side will hear you perfectly. It is 257 steps up.**
Checked against <https://www.stpauls.co.uk/explore-our-map>



An ear: the instrument you check things with.

WHERE OUR FACTS CAME FROM • THE LIST

Unit 2: The Sound Cupboard

- **Every sound in the world is made by something wobbling to and fro. We call that wobbling a vibration, and it makes the air wobble too.**
Checked against <https://www.britannica.com/science/sound-physics>
- **Space is completely silent. There is no air out there for sound to travel through, so a rocket zooming past would make no noise at all.**
Checked against <https://www.britannica.com/science/sound-physics>
- **When you hit a drum, the skin on top stretches and springs back very fast. That shaking pushes the air, and the pushed air is the boom you hear.**
Checked against https://www.yamaha.com/en/musical_instrument_guide/drums/mechanism/mechanism003.html
- **Deep inside your ear is a tiny skin called the eardrum. Sound makes it wobble, and it passes the wobble on to the three smallest bones in your whole body.**
Checked against <https://www.nidcd.nih.gov/health/how-do-we-hear>
- **Your ears can hear about 20 wobbles a second at the lowest and 20,000 a second at the highest. Anything slower or faster is silent to you.**
Checked against <https://www.britannica.com/science/sound-physics>
- **A cricket has no voice at all. He makes his chirp by rubbing one wing quickly across the other, a little like a bow across a violin string.**
Checked against <https://www.si.edu/stories/why-dont-female-crickets-chirp>

WHERE OUR FACTS CAME FROM • THE LIST • CONTINUED

- **Elephants talk to each other in rumbles so low and deep that human ears cannot hear them at all. Sometimes you can feel one in the air instead.**
Checked against <https://www.birds.cornell.edu/ccb/elephant-listening-project/sound>
- **Bats shout as they fly and listen for the echo bouncing back, which is how they find their way in the dark. Most of their shouting is far too high for us to hear.**
Checked against <https://www.nps.gov/subjects/bats/echolocation.htm>
- **The loudest sound any animal makes belongs to the sperm whale. Its clicks are far louder than a clap of thunder.**
Checked against <https://www.guinnessworldrecords.com/world-records/70669-loudest-animal-sound>
- **A big drum has more air inside it to shake, and big things shake more slowly. Slow shaking makes a low sound, so the biggest drum in the band is always the deepest.**
Checked against https://www.yamaha.com/en/musical_instrument_guide/drums/mechanism/mechanism003.html
- **In a recorder, it is a column of air that is really singing. A short pipe holds a short column of air, and short columns sing high notes.**
Checked against https://www.ux1.eiu.edu/~addavis/3050/Adventures/chapter_12/ch12_2.htm



A triangle, hung by its cord so it can ring.

WHERE OUR FACTS CAME FROM · THE LIST

Unit 3: The Long Bench

- **Very early on a spring morning, hundreds of birds sing all at once. The air is stillest then and the world is quiet, so their songs carry much further than they would later in the day.**
Checked against <https://www.woodlandtrust.org.uk/blog/2019/04/dawn-chorus>
- **In one American cave, someone turned the stone icicles hanging from the roof into a giant instrument. Little rubber hammers tap the stones.**
Checked against <https://www.guinnessworldrecords.com/world-records/83581-largest-natural-underground-musical-instrument>
- **Your heart is the drum you were born with, and it beats faster than a grown-up's. A six-year-old's heart can beat over 100 times a minute while a grown-up's beats about 70.**
Checked against https://www.nottsapc.nhs.uk/media/vv2jppti/bp_and_hr_monitoring_for_children.pdf
- **An echo is your own voice coming back to you. The sound flies off, bumps into a wall or a cliff, and bounces home like a ball.**
Checked against <https://www.britannica.com/science/echo-physics>
- **Soldiers are often told to break step and walk normally when they cross a bridge. A whole column stamping the same beat can make a bridge wobble.**
Checked against <https://www.britannica.com/science/resonance-vibration>



A signpost. Every fact here points somewhere real.

WHERE OUR FACTS CAME FROM • THE LIST

Unit 4: The Platform

- **Sound goes more than four times faster through water than through air. Whales use that to send messages a very long way.**
Checked against <https://www.britannica.com/science/sound-physics>
- **Sound races through iron about thirteen times faster than through air. That is why a train's rumble reaches the rails long before the sound reaches you through the air.**
Checked against <https://www.britannica.com/science/sound-physics>
- **The little metal fork that musicians ping to find the right note was invented over 300 years ago by a trumpet player called John Shore.**
Checked against <https://www.whipplemuseum.cam.ac.uk/explore-whipple-collections/acoustics/historical-notes-brief-chronicle-tuning-fork>
- **Light travels much faster than sound, so you always see the lightning before you hear the thunder. Count the seconds in between: every three seconds means the storm is about a kilometre away.**
Checked against <https://www.weather.gov/safety/lightning-science-thunder>
- **When a train rushes past you, its whistle sounds high as it comes and suddenly drops low as it goes. The whistle never changes: it is the rushing past that changes what your ears hear.**
Checked against <https://www.britannica.com/science/Doppler-effect>



A ticket. Somebody checked this one.

WHERE OUR FACTS CAME FROM • THE LIST

Unit 5: The Full Stage

- **The oldest musical instruments anyone has found are little flutes carved from bird bone and mammoth ivory, discovered in a cave in Germany. They are over 40,000 years old.**
Checked against <https://www.bbc.com/news/science-environment-18196349>
- **One of the largest musical instruments in the world is an organ with over 33,000 pipes. Its smallest pipe is shorter than your finger and its largest is taller than a house.**
Checked against https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Boardwalk_Hall_Auditorium_Organ
- **Before a concert, the whole orchestra tunes up to one note played by the oboe. Its sound is so clear that every single player can pick it out.**
Checked against https://www.yamaha.com/en/musical_instrument_guide/oboe/trivia
- **In ancient Greece only a few actors played all the parts. They swapped masks to become a new character in a moment, and the big painted faces helped people right at the back see who was who.**
Checked against <https://kids.britannica.com/students/article/mask/275724>
- **A Greek theatre built over 2,000 years ago lets 14,000 people hear an actor with no microphone at all. Scientists found the secret is the rows of stone seats, which quietly soak up the rumble of the crowd.**
Checked against <https://www.sciencedaily.com/releases/2007/04/070404162237.htm>
- **Theatre curtains are made of thick, heavy velvet so the audience cannot hear the bumps and whispers backstage. They have mostly been red since Victorian times, but before that they were often green, blue or silver.**
Checked against
https://europeantheatrelexicon.mimesisjournals.com/european_theatre_lexicon_item_detail.php?item_id=120

WHERE OUR FACTS CAME FROM • THE LIST • CONTINUED

- **Actors think it is unlucky to say good luck, so instead they say break a leg. Nobody knows for certain how such a strange saying began.**
Checked against https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Break_a_leg
- **Roman plays often ended with the actor calling out plaudite, which meant clap. Our word applause grew from that very same word.**
Checked against <https://www.bbc.com/future/article/20240523-why-do-we-clap>



A rosette, for the end of the year.

PRIME BOOKS

My certificate

Music & Acting, Year 1

This certificate belongs to

My favourite song this year

The instrument I liked best

What I performed in the big show

Signed by my teacher

PRIME SCHOOL

CAMBRIDGE EARLY YEARS

FOR TEACHERS



Every topic in the scheme, mapped to its page.

The scheme map

Every topic in the scheme of work, in the sheet's own order and its own wording, against the pupil-facing title used in this book.

The pupil-facing titles are written for a five-year-old to read aloud. The scheme wording is preserved underneath each one so that any page can be matched to a planning document without guesswork. Nothing in the scheme has been dropped, merged or reordered: all 25 topics appear, in 5 units, and the build refuses to run if that is not true.

FOR TEACHERS • CONTINUED

1.1	Wake up your voice Vocal warm ups and exploring voices
1.2	Songs we already know Sharing favourite songs and nursery rhymes
1.3	Learning a song, line by line Learning a new song (line by line, with actions)
1.4	I sing, you sing Group singing (call and response / turn-taking)
1.5	Our first show Performance and class reflection
2.1	Open the sound cupboard Explore classroom instruments and sound-making objects
2.2	Loud and soft, high and low, fast and slow Experiment with loud/soft, high/low, fast/slow
2.3	Make a sound pattern Create short sound patterns (with movement)
2.4	Listen to the world outside Listening and responding to environmental sounds
2.5	Play it together Group performance and reflection
3.1	Music that goes somewhere Listening to journey-themed music (e.g. trains, walking)
3.2	Walk to the pulse Pulse and rhythm activities through movement
3.3	Chanting along the way Singing and chanting journey songs

FOR TEACHERS • CONTINUED

3.4	Build a journey out of sound Soundscapes of journeys using instruments
3.5	Show us your journey Small group performance and reflection
4.1	Cars, planes and boats Explore travel sounds (cars, planes, boats) vocally and instrumentally
4.2	A travelling song Learn a travel-themed song (with actions)
4.3	Make a travel pattern Compose short rhythmic or melodic patterns for travel
4.4	Put the pieces in order Perform sequences with instruments and voices
4.5	Looking back at Unit 4 Reflection and assessment
5.1	All our favourite songs Revise favourite songs learned during the year
5.2	Add a drum, add a shake Add percussion parts to songs
5.3	Make our celebration piece Create a short class celebration piece
5.4	Rehearse it properly Rehearse for performance (whole class)
5.5	The big show Final performance and reflection

FOR TEACHERS • CONTINUED • CONTINUED

 FOR TEACHERS

The four-part loop printed at the front of the book (listen, try, choose, show) maps onto the Cambridge Early Years expressive arts strands and the English national curriculum Key Stage 1 music programme of study. Each topic's outcomes are written as pupil-facing I can statements, and the end-of-unit checklists reuse the same wording so assessment and teaching are not two separate vocabularies.

Rhythm work is arithmetically verified. Every rhythm printed in this book is generated from a single source that proves each bar fills its time signature and refuses note values the relevant unit has not yet taught, so the syllables, the stick notation and the words cannot disagree with one another.

Singing ranges are constrained to a comfortable Year 1 compass and checked before printing, so no printed tune asks for a note outside it.



Eight bars, longest to shortest. Long bars are low.

PRIME BOOKS STUDENT MANUALS

Music & Acting

Year 1

A whole year in the Hedgerow Theatre. Wake your voice up in the green room, open the sound cupboard, walk the pulse along the long bench, build a journey out of sound on the platform, and put it all together on the full stage.

Twenty-five topics, eleven traditional songs printed in full, and a big show at the end. Every fact checked, every rhythm counted, every song's words free for everybody to sing.

CAMBRIDGE EARLY YEARS

PRIME SCHOOL

